



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

SECOND MEETING, 2025

Wednesday, 2nd July, 2025

The House met at 12.57 p.m.

[MR SECOND DEPUTY SPEAKER
IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, kindly turn to the item numbered 5 — *Correction of Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Reports*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORTS**

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we would start with the *Votes and Proceedings* of Tuesday, 1st July, 2025.

Page 1...8—

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I would wish if the Clerks-at-the-Table could check the item numbered 5(b)(iv) which reads:

“Staff and Pupils of Alogboshie ‘1’ Basic School from Okaikwei North Constituency, led by the Head Teacher, Eunice Die.”

I do not know the pronunciation of the surname of the Head Teacher and actually, I do not know any local name that represents “Die”, but the name of the

person is Mrs Eunice “Didana”. I am not sure of the D-i-e.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Table, check and let us do the right thing.

Page 9—

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, let me respectfully invite you to the item numbered 7 at page 9, under “STATEMENTS”. I recall that yesterday, the Minister for Health was in this Chamber to brief the House on the outbreak of COVID-19 and he also added that of Mpox, but from the record we have here, Mpox is conspicuously missing. I think the Clerks-at-the-Table need to take account of that.

Mr Speaker, I am a product of the University of Ghana and the name of our school is University of Ghana, Legon. If we look at it over here, the item numbered 7(i), line 4, I think that the rendition is incomplete. It should read, “University of Ghana, Legon”, then I know we are taking about my true *alma mater*.

Mr Boamah and Mr Annoh-Dompreh — *rose* —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: All right, Table.

Let me listen to Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah, then I would come to you, Minority Chief Whip.

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah: Mr Speaker, ordinarily, I would not intervene. I heard my Hon Colleague from Afadjato

South allude to the Statement made by the Minister for Health yesterday. Mr Speaker, last Friday, the Business Statement specifically asked the Minister for Health to brief the House on COVID-19 matters on the University of Ghana campus. He heeded to the call of the House and spoke to those issues, but in the Statement he made on the Floor, he made mention of Mpox and what the Ministry was doing. He also spoke about Cholera. My notes are clear.

So, I do not know if the Member is asking the Table to capture all those issues in the *Votes and Proceedings* since there were other public health issues that he spoke about. That is the clarification I seek from you.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, just to speak in support of what Hon Patrick Yaw Boamah spoke to, I think there was a specific referral and one can refer to the Business Statement. The crux of the referral was to COVID-19. The other matters that came up were just by the way. Yes, so they were ancillary health concerns that he spoke to and that cannot change the specific referral that was made. So, Mr Speaker, I think it is right as it is.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member for Afadjato South, the *Official Report* would capture the details of it.

Mr Afriyie: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Deh — rose —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Yes, Hon Member, do you also want to speak? Let us hear you.

Mr Sebastian Fred Deh: Mr Speaker, I rise to seek your guidance on the appearance of my name and that of two others under the—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Which page are you talking about?

Mr Deh: Page 7.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: You are taking us back.

Mr Deh: Mr Speaker, you got to page 7; you did not go beyond.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Which item at page 7?

Mr Deh: My name is there, but yesterday, I think that the understanding—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, listen to me. Which item at page 7?

Mr Deh: Mr Speaker, under “The following Hon Members were absent:”, “absent” not qualified. We have “absent with permission” as the item numbered 3, and “The following Hon Members were absent:”. The reason—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: No, what is your number or name?

Mr Deh: Mr Speaker, the item number 15.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Is that “Sebastian Fred Deh”?

Mr Deh: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Were you here?

Mr Deh: Mr Speaker, we were in a Committee meeting yesterday and we were made to understand that our names were being forwarded to Mr Speaker for it to be entered accordingly. So, if there was “Absent with permission”, then that should have been qualified in the records.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. It appears the names were not transmitted to the Table. That notwithstanding, I would ask the Clerks-at-the-Table to check. Which Committee are you talking about?

1.07 p.m.

Mr Deh: That was the Public Accounts Committee.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Table, kindly check if indeed he was at Public Accounts Committee and please acknowledge him as present.

Mr Deh: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Page 10?

Yes, Hon Member for Effia.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. On page 10, under Presentation of Papers, the item

numbered 8(a) reads “Financing Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana ...” and it ends with “...to finance the Second Resilient Recovery Development Policy Financing.” Mr Speaker, the documents we reviewed yesterday did not have “financing” at the end of it. It is supposed to be “to finance the Second Resilient Recovery Development Policy”. That is what I have.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Which item?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Item numbered 8(a). I have the Paper with me now so Table Office could take notice and do the correction and correct subsequent repetition of same on pages 12, 13, 14 and 15. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, I think we can do away with the “financing” and end with “policy”. I think that can do. So, Table should kindly take note of that.

Please, let us turn to page 11...15—

Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, in respect of the correction effected by my Brother, if you see item numbered 11 on page 15, “financing” is again inserted after “policy” so Table Office should consequentially effect the changes.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Table Office should consequentially take note of that. Thank you very much.

Page 14...16—

Yes, Hon First Deputy Speaker?

Mr Bernard Ahiafor: Mr Speaker, let me take you back to the issue of the financing agreement. What the *Votes and Proceedings* has captured is correct.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Policy Financing?

Mr Ahiafor: Yes, Policy—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us do it this way. I will ask the Table to check the original agreement and effect the changes.

Mr Ahiafor: Yes, because at page 10, it said the following Papers were presented. And it is “Financing Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry...)”. The capturing is correct.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I think they are talking about “to finance the Second Resilient Recovery Development Policy Financing”

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I think the issue is about whether there is “financing” after “policy”.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, exactly.

Mr Dafeamekpor: So, it is that correction the Hon Member is referring to which runs through page 13 to 15. So, it is just the rendition that the Table Office should get accurate. That is all.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But that notwithstanding, the Table should check the original agreement that was transmitted to Parliament.

Yes, Prof Nyarko?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, as much as they have to look at the original agreement, you must also look at the Order Paper because that will give a reflection on what has been captured in the *Votes and Proceedings*.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, Prof, what we are saying is that we want the original document that was transmitted to Parliament. So, we are asking the Table to look at that so that they capture it accordingly.

Page 16...19—

Yes, Prof Nyarko?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, on page, 18 item 3(xi), I have seen this “Julliet Oppong Boateng”. Respectfully, let us check if the “Julliet” is rather “Juliet”. So, let us check and reconcile and get it right because the person works in Parliament.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, Table, check the way the person registered her name.

Page 19, 20—

Yes?

Mr Afriyie: Thank you so much. It is just a minor correction. Mr Speaker, on

item numbered 3, there is a need for some typing realignment. If you look at under “In Attendance”, your good self, “Mr Andrew Asiamah Amoako, Hon MP and Second Deputy Speaker, the “Deputy Speaker” has rather been brought to where the names are, so if they could take note and realign. The same occurred at 3 (iii), that is with respect to “Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib”. Thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Ahiafor?

Mr Ahiafor: Mr Speaker, what is contained at page 20 is correct. Page 21 is also correct because in attendance, Mr Andrew Asiamah Amoako, Hon MP and Second Deputy Speaker”. Since the line is not long, that is where the Deputy Speaker is supposed to be. It does not mean that this particular place is for names. The same thing applies to the Deputy Whip, so I think there is nothing wrong the way it is captured.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Page 21—

Yes?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, on page 21, (xxiii), “Togbe Honoafe” is supposed to be “Togbe Honofe”

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Thank you. Table, kindly take note.

Page 22,23—

Yes, Hon Member for Afadjato South?

Mr Afriyie: Thank you, Mr Speaker. On Page 23, (xliii), I think the name of the institution over there is “Ghana Academy of Arts and Sciences” not “Ghana Academy of Arts and Science”. The Clerks-at-the-Table should take note and correct accordingly. Thank you.

1.17 p.m.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: All right, Table, kindly acknowledge the correction.

Page 24, 25—

Yes, Hon Member for Afadjato South?

Mr Afriyie: Thank you once again. Please, may I walk you to page 25, the item numbered lxi. The word should be “freight forwarder”; what we have here is “freight farwarder”. The “a” after “f” should be deleted and an “o” inserted. Thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Table, kindly acknowledge the correction.

Then finally, page 26.

Hon Members, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Tuesday, 1st July, 2025, as corrected, is hereby adopted as the true records of proceedings.

Hon Members, I have in my hands the 20th June, 2025 edition of the *Official Report*.

Yes, Hon Prof Nyarko?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, the *Official Report* has not been distributed to Members. So, I got here early, went to the Table and they said that they did not have them. So, for me, I think it is appropriate for us to have them to read so that we can make meaningful corrections on them. As we speak, I do not know if any of our Colleagues on the other Side have the *Official Report*.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, do you have the *Official Report*?

Some Members from the Majority Side: Yes.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: You have it?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, they are magicians. How did they get them?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, inasmuch as we are ensuring that the Reports are loaded online, we also encourage to get our Personal Assistants (PAs) to retrieve them from our pigeonholes. So, I, for instance got mine this morning. So, I want to urge Prof Nyarko that he should allow this to go so that subsequently — because if he makes the effort, he will get his copy. I have my copy.

Prof Nyarko: You can proceed, but they are not in the pigeonholes.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. I think we have discussed this before. So, we are now online; yes.

Hon Member for Okere?

Mr Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I think that I am one of the people who have always been talking about this. It is not just enough to put it on the console because it goes every day. We have that of 24th and 25th June, 2025 in our e-mails, but we do not have that of 20th June, 2025 in the e-mail.

I keep saying this, that, Mr Speaker, we are not just here to just run through *Official Reports*. We are supposed to really have time for them and once it is in our e-mail, that we can have perpetual access to them. But the ones they put on this console, the next day it goes away and even we do not have them. So, I urge the Table Office and the IT Department to be putting these things in our e-mails so that we can have access to them. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think that is a very brilliant suggestion. That we should all submit our e-mails to the IT team and then let them configure it in such a way that any time that they load, it also goes straight to our inboxes and then we have copies. We can read them anywhere we are. I think it is a very good idea.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Professor Beyuo?

Prof Titus Kofi Beyuo: Mr Speaker, it is in our e-mail. I have an e-mail sent to me on Thursday, and has *Official Reports* of 17th, 18th, 19th, and 20th June, 2025. Yes; the official e-mail.

The second set of e-mails that he is talking about came today. So that new set is 24th to 25th June, 2025. So, it is in the e-mail. I think he has found it. Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Yes, Prof Nyarko? *[Interruption]*

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, almost every day I check my e-mail and when one checks their e-mail, the *Votes and Proceedings* at times are sent to us. At times, they are not sent. I have to call the ICT Department and they do the needful.

With the *Official Reports*, at times they do, at times they do not and the issue is that you might not be sure which ones Mr Speaker has. So, the point we are making is that let us do it right. Today, for example, the first thing that I did was to enquire from them at the Table. It was not there and I did not avert my mind to check from the console. But if we have hard copies or if we are preempted that we are going to look at these numbers of *Official Reports*, then Members can take their time to prepare and go through them, proffer and offer some useful corrections. That is what we are asking. This is not something we need to litigate upon.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I think he is making a valid point. As much as we could have so many of the *Official Reports* in our e-mail and we would not know which one we are going to actually take, I think the Table can do us good if they can tell us each day which *Official Report* we are going to take so that Members can prepare ahead of time. I think we will take that.

Hon Members, in the absence of any corrections, the *Official Report* —

Dr Mahama — rose —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you have something to say? Very well.

Dr Mahama?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, on column 38, the fourth paragraph; it reads, “I am looking at the Questions programme”. Mr Speaker, I wanted to say “Questions programmed”, not “Questions programme”. I mean, the two may be different; they are definitely different. “Questions programme” and “Questions programmed” are two different things. What I was referring to is “Questions programmed” for the ensuing week. So, I want the Table to take notice of that and probably correct that to “Questions programmed” with a “d”.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Table, take note of that.

Hon Members, the *Official Report* of Friday, 20th June, 2025, as corrected, is hereby adopted as the true records of proceedings.

Hon Members, before we turn to the next item on the Order Paper, kindly indulge me to acknowledge our students at the Public Gallery.

The first set of school is Akatsi Senior High Technical School. They are being led by Samson Shine-Amega, the Head of Department of Business Department. And The school is located in Akatsi South Constituency.

[Pupils from Akatsi Senior High Technical School were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker, I hope you are going to take care of them.

Mr Bernard Ahiafor: Yes.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

1.27 p.m.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Tongor Senior High Technical School—Songo Senior High Technical School. They are led by Wonder Abah, who is the teacher—

Mr Dafeamekpor — *rose* —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But I have not called you, so why are you on your feet? The school is located in the South Dayi Constituency.

Majority Chief Whip.

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I wanted to align your pronunciation with Tongor; it is actually Tongor.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you, but after correcting me, make sure you take care of them.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is a matter of course.

[Pupils of Tongor Senior High Technical School were acknowledged]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: The last school is Beposo D/A Basic 'A' School. They are led by Yunusa Yakubu, who is the head teacher. The school is located in the Shama Constituency.

Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture?

Mrs Emelia Arthur: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Have you seen your students?

Mrs Arthur: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I hope you are going to take good care of them.

Students, I hope you are monitoring what is going on. This should urge you on to study hard so that tomorrow you can take care of your constituents as representatives. You are welcome, and I wish you well.

[Pupils of Beposo D/A Basic 'A' School were acknowledged]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Leaders, are we going to take Questions or Statements?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we have the Ministers here, so let us do the Questions.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, before we start the Questions, I want to urge you to take a look at the Order Paper. We have three Urgent Questions and 22 Oral Questions, which is 25 in total. We can make headway if we cooperate with—

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I would like to crave your indulgence. The Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs has reached out to the other Side, and there is an understanding that he will come back tomorrow to answer his Questions.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs often comes to the Chamber. He is not like the others.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But your Friend, the Minister for Roads and Highways, is always here. It is that we just did not see him last week.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Roads and Highways does not fit into that category. Those who fit into that category know themselves. I would gladly support. I have not mentioned anybody's name.

Mr Speaker, I think we can proceed.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, we will begin with the Hon Minister for Energy and Green Transition.

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah: Just to find out if he is here to answer Questions, or if he has brought a new levy. I just want to be sure.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: New levy on what?

Mr Boamah: On petroleum products.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: The suspended one?

Mr Boamah: The one coming back on the 16th.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Minority Leader is not here, so the Minority Chief Whip will ask the Question on his behalf. So, we will take Question 'a' which stands in the name of Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin, Hon Member for Effutu.

URGENT QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF ENERGY AND GREEN TRANSITION

Reforms to Mitigate Illegal Electricity Connection

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh on behalf of Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin (NPP—Effutu): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition what

reforms are being implemented at ECG to mitigate illegal electricity connection and meeting challenges to improve revenue efficiency.

Minister for Energy and Green Transition (Mr John Abdulai Jinapor): Mr Speaker, measures being adopted to mitigate illegal electricity connection and metering challenges to improve revenue efficiency.

We have embarked on a loss reduction programme, which is part of the reforms being undertaken by the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG), among others, to reduce commercial losses, improve energy accounting through the installation of meter management systems, compliant repayment meters, specifically, replacement of over-aged and obsolete meters, replacement of faulty meters, and installation of new service connections. Under the loss reduction programme, about one million meters have been installed already in order to ensure that we have accurate billing. These are smart meters that provide underscored information so that we can reduce the losses the Hon Member is talking about.

We are also rerouting concealed service deals and deploying enhanced meter management systems. A total of about 1.2 million meters management systems have so far been installed as of the end of April 2025. In addition to this, ECG plans to install an additional two million meters between 2025 and 2029, to be complemented by another one million, which is being rolled out in collaboration with the World Bank.

The use of smart meters by itself does not automatically lead to a reduction in losses. So smart metres sometimes have challenges, and the human element is also being improved. We have given ECG some Key Performance Indicators (KPIs). The Cabinet has also approved that all state institutions be put on prepayment meters or agree with ECG for a monthly billing and payment system. Only four institutions, the Presidency, Police Service, the Military, and education and hospitals, have been put in a different category. Even with them, they are supposed to pay for the light bills, except that they would not be on prepayment meters.

The Electricity Company of Ghana has also constituted some tax force, and they are making progress. Mr Speaker, recently, Hon Members would have heard that some estates have been busted and the owners are being arraigned. I am happy to announce that there has been some significant improvement in the revenue collection following these measures that we have put in place. With these measures, we are confident that going forward, we will have improvement in revenue collection, reduce losses, and bring about overall efficiency as far as the electricity sector is concerned.

Thank you very much.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Minister spoke to an approval given by the Cabinet for the installation of prepaid meters at all state institutions with just a few exceptions. So, when is

he implementing this approval? Is it the case that the approval has come, and he is now thinking about when to start or implement?

1.37 p.m.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, we have actually started implementation and the Hon Member would have heard that some agencies of Government were put off recently. We only had to agree on a payment schedule with them to reconnect them. So, let me assure the Minority Leader that we have already commenced this exercise, following the approval from the Cabinet.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Annoh-Dompreh?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I have confidence in the Minister, but we will come back to this story some other time. He said they have already started. I do not want him to give me any particulars, but we get stories of meters in the hands of fraudsters. Some fraudsters owe meters and confidently go about installing them. I am sure it all comes in wake with the subject matter, which is illegal electricity connection, and the improvement in revenue efficiency. If this has come to the notice of the Hon Minister, are there any measures to track down on these activities?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, that is absolutely true, but we have been working with stakeholders to deal with that challenge and ensure that we nip that in the bud. Ordinarily, it is ECG that has

the mandate to install meters, so we are working on a Legislative Instrument (L.I.) to be submitted to Parliament, so that the penalty and the penal measures will be quite severe to serve as a deterrent to those who otherwise own such meters. We have been arresting and prosecuting people. In fact, there is a dedicated court for such offences. In collaboration with this House, we intend to bring that legislation, so that we can make the punishment severe. It is not only ECG. In Tamale, for instance, yesterday, when our men from Northern Electricity Department Company (NEDCo) went on an exercise, some of them were attacked.

Mr Speaker, let me also use this opportunity to make a passionate and humble appeal to Ghanaians that if we do not work with these utilities to ensure that we are able to recover the revenues, we are going to have a major challenge providing power.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I will give you the last chance.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, is the Minister able to apprise this House of the number of state institutions which are on the bill, in terms of those that have been earmarked to be installed with prepaid meters? I know he mentioned a few exceptions: the Presidency and all that. Can he run us through the list?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, if you have the records, you can answer; if not, we can ask you to come again.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am spot on Order 89. I am not offensive of the Order.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But as I sit here, I can say that you are off— Because if you ask him to apprise you of all the institutions, obviously, it could be that he did not prepare for that. So, we can bring him here specifically on that.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I will not contest your position. I will respect it. My question is flowing from his own answers. So, if we have to defer this for another day, that is fine. Maybe, he has the list.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, once you give me the opportunity, I will submit the list to this House within the shortest possible time.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, thank you so much.

In answering the Question, the Hon Minister told us some of the measures the Ministry has put in place to deal with the illegal connection and, in so doing, there has been some improvements in the revenue mobilisation. I would like to know from the Minister if he will be kind enough to let us know how much have we been able to make in terms of the enhanced revenue he is talking about.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, if you are minded—

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, at the end of this month, for instance, ECG was able to raise about GH¢1.6 billion,

which is a remarkable improvement year on year—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Is it billion or million?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, it is GH¢1.6 billion, which is a remarkable improvement, even though the target ought to be GH¢2.5 billion. But if you do a year-on-year comparison, what it means is that this month of 2025, as compared to same month 2024, there is a remarkable improvement in terms of the revenue collection.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: As for Prof, I will give him another slot.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, at the heart of the challenges we are facing at the power sector, especially revenue mobilisation from those within that enclave, has to do with political will. I heard the Hon Minister spoke about arresting some individuals who engage in illegal connection.

Mr Speaker, I would like to find from the Hon Minister how we would ensure that we have the political will in order not to undermine the measures the Ministry is putting in place. Because for me, that is the core reason we are not able to get the necessary revenue. So, political will at play, how would we ensure that when persons are apprehended, we will deal with them according to law and not allow political interference to let them loose?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, let me assure this House that, so far as I

remain Minister for this sector, I will give them every support; the utility companies have my full blessing. Cabinet has taken a decision and it is not easy for Cabinet to decide that all Government-owned agencies be put on prepayment meters, so I know that we have support from the highest level. But it cannot be the Ministry alone. All of us have to work together.

Mr Speaker, I was just whispering to the Majority Leader that, very soon, we will be visiting Parliament to have a discussion with Parliament on how we can work together. From my office at the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition, we are on a prepayment meter and we pay ourselves to serve as a roadmap for others. So, we count on the support of Parliament and I know that the Committee on Energy has been very helpful and instrumental in the work and, together, if we continue on this trajectory, I am very sure that we will make significant progress.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we will hold on with the Urgent Questions (b) and (c) and deal with the Oral Answers to Questions for Mr John Jinapor. Then afterwards, we come to Mr Govers Agbodza.

So, on that note, we will turn to the Question numbered 170 and the Question stands in the name of Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin.

Hon Annoh-Dompreh, you may take the Question on his behalf.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF ENERGY AND GREEN TRANSITION

Measures by ECG to Reduce Technical and Commercial Losses

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh on behalf of Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin (NPP — Effutu): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition what specific measures are being implemented by the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG) to reduce technical and commercial losses under the loss reduction programme.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: It appears the Question is similar or the same to the previous one.

Minister for Energy and Green Transition (Mr John Abdulai Jinapor): Mr Speaker, with your permission, what I answered basically answers this. Because if we are reducing technical losses, we are improving revenue collection, so, in the energy space, we have something we call the Aggregate Technical Collection and Commercial Losses (ATCC). When we put in place measures and policies, we are seeking to achieve all these.

1.47 p.m.

Mr Speaker, with your permission, if it suits you, I may plead that the *Hansard* captures what has been written as the Answer, but if you direct that I read everything too, so be it.

Mr Speaker, the specific interventions being deployed by ECG as part of the Loss Reduction Programme (LRP) projects to mitigate illegal electricity connection and metering challenges to reduce technical and commercial losses, to include the following:

Boundary Metering

This project is being implemented with the objective of installing MMS compliant meters at all regional and district boundary points to enhance comprehensive upstream and downstream energy audit to identify areas with high system aggregate losses. The installation of boundary meters has been completed in five out of the 10 ECG operational regions namely Western, Central, Eastern, Volta and Tema. The remaining five are currently ongoing.

Distribution Transformer (DT) Metering

Distribution Transformer (DT) metering project is ongoing, with the objective to install MMS compliant smart meters on all Distribution Transformers across ECG operational areas as well as downstream energy audit to identify commercial losses and improve transformer load management.

So far, 3,349 DT meters have been installed out of a total of 30,000. The Ministry is currently facilitating the release of the meters stuck at the port. The contractor is expected to expedite the rate of installation once the required materials are cleared from the port soon.

Flat Rate Billing

Flat Rate Billing has been adopted for customers who have not had meters installed after payments or have faulty meters yet to be replaced. This temporary measure is helping to account for sales which hitherto, could not have been obtained. This interim measure by the management of ECG is intended to prevent customers connecting directly thereby minimising commercial losses.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I tend to share that the two Questions are similar, but the Minister will admit that the earlier Question has an aspect that has to do with illegal electricity connectivity. So, we could then say that *Hansard* should capture the aspect that talks about the losses, and that should be it.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: That is very good.

Yes, Prof Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, the Minister is my very good Friend and he is a sharp man.

Mr Speaker, because this Question is a bit specific in a way, though akin to the earlier one, this one talks about technical and commercial losses and I want to find out from him, per the PURC benchmark, how they are ensuring that technical and commercial losses are within the gamut set by a PURC. I want to know how they would ensure that because that

intervention might be different from what he said earlier.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, like I said, if we put government agencies on pre-payment meters, we are reducing technical losses, commercial losses and collection losses. If we form a task force to move around to identify illegal connections, prosecute people and bail them, we are addressing the same thing. If we replace meters with smart meters that are up-to-date and can communicate on the spot, real-time information, we are doing that. That was why I went further to say that we are installing boundary meters. What the boundary meters do is that they take the bulk amount consumed and reconcile with the individual meters and if there is a huge disparity or differential, it tells us that that area has a big problem, so that we can zero down on those areas. So, we are really working.

When I assumed office, the losses were pegged at around 40 per cent. I know that, as we speak, we are around 30 per cent and below. If we continue to drill down, we would be within the band of the PURC.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member of Parliament for Okere Constituency?

Mr Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth: Mr Speaker, one observation is that when a person goes to our communities,

particularly the rural areas, they will find that very few people have meters. So, we would see they use bamboos and other trees to do very long connections. Electricity is a very essential commodity that everybody needs, but the challenges in even acquiring meters from ECG becomes a problem for some of these rural communities and we always have inundated requests to help our communities to get ECG meters.

I believe that, per the Response of the Minister, meters and obsolete meters are one of the reasons that is culminating in these losses. What is the Ministry doing, in terms of its own initiative, to produce mass meters and make them available and ensure very flexible ways of acquiring meters from ECG, so that some of these challenges that are not created by the communities can be willingly solved?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minister? It is a thesis, yes. Today you have met your “meeter”.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, that is true. We have to work and improve on meters, but it is not always the case that meters solve problems. For instance, if one has a container where they sell tomatoes and they use one bulb and probably, one fan, if we put a smart meter there, we will lose. This is because the revenue we will get from that person will not be enough to retire the meter, let alone pay for ECG. That is why sometimes, we give them flat rates. So, based on the circumstance, we have to be innovative and adapt to the exigencies of the situation.

We are reviewing all this metering, procurement and delivery issues. One, we want to ensure that there is value for money when it comes to the cost of the meter. Two, we want to ensure that we put the right meters at the right places. Three, and more importantly, we are reviewing whether to go by the current state where ECG has to procure and supply. In some advanced areas, one buys the meter, they send a code and it is activated. Without the code, the meter will not be activated. We are looking at all these options and we will adapt as and when it becomes necessary.

Thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: We now turn to the Question numbered 133 and it stands in the name of Hon Kwame Gakpey, Member for Keta.

Yes, Kwame, let us hear you.

Strategies to Enhance Revenue Collection to Reduce Debt Accumulation

Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (NDC — Keta): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition what strategies are being implemented to enhance revenue collection in order to reduce debt accumulation in the energy sector.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, the strategies being implemented to enhance revenue collection in order to reduce debt accumulation in the energy sector are as follows:

- Implementation of a Single Revenue Holding Account

Following the directives by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition in February 2025, the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG) has established a Single Holding Account to enhance visibility and accountability in revenue collection. This account aggregates revenues from all ECG district and regional offices, allowing for streamlined monitoring and reporting.

- Regulatory Oversight of ECG Collections

The single holding bank, GCB Bank, submits a monthly report on ECG collections to the Public Utilities Regulatory Commission (PURC) on the 26th of each month, with PURC providing verification and approval for further action by the Cash Waterfall Mechanism (CWM) Committee by the 27th of each month. This mechanism ensures timely and transparent reporting of electricity revenues.

- Macroeconomic Support

Recent reforms and policy measures undertaken by Government have significantly contributed to exchange rate stability, bolstering the value of the Ghana cedi against the US dollar. This has had a positive impact on revenue performance and helped to mitigate foreign exchange-related losses in energy sector transactions. As at June this year, the forex rate has reduced from GHS16.33 per US\$1 to GHS10.23 per US\$1.

Since February 2025, ECG has been mandated to focus on its core business and stay away from fuel purchases. The CWM makes allocation for planned and emergency fuel purchases. This has freed moneys hitherto used by ECG to procure fuel to pay other service providers in the value chain.

- **Regulatory Oversight**

The PURC and the EC are also revising the Performance Improvement Plans (PIPs) of distribution companies to enable closer monitoring of their expenditure throughout the year. This initiative aims to reduce liabilities and enforce stricter controls on operating expenses.

Mr Speaker, the Question has to do with how to reduce debt accumulation. Indeed, the debt accumulation has seen a reduction. As at June, the amount paid to Independent Power Producers (IPPs) equals what was paid to IPPs for the whole of 2024. If we look at the figure that the IPPs have received from ECG for this year, by middle of the year, we had reached what was paid to IPPs the whole of last year. So, we talked to the IPPs; we would try to stay current, based on what we inherited in terms of the arrangement from the previous Administration.

Aside that, I have directed, as Minister, that ECG closes all their accounts, which they have complied, and operate one single account. With that single account, all of us, as Minister, PURC, Energy Commission can monitor the amount that comes into the account. We have also directed that they make no

payments until the end of the month, so that we can use the CWM to apportion and distribute the revenue. So far, that has shown to give some positive results.

We are also lucky that through the hard work of the Minister for Finance, the exchange rate has dropped from about the 17 per cent we witnessed before to about 10.5 per cent now. That alone shaves off about 30 per cent of our debt in cedi terms.

Also, we are tightening regulatory oversight. We are pursuing a lot of reforms. I am very confident in the current management of the ECG headed by Ing Julius Kpekpena. They are cutting down on expenditure, realigning expenditure and prioritising expenditure and all of these end up reducing the rate of accumulation. I am happy to note that the rate of accumulation, in terms of the compounding of the debt, is reducing significantly.

Thank you very much.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Gakpey, are you all right? No supplementary question?

Mr Gakpey: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Wonderful.

Yes, Hon Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, from the Responses by the able Minister this morning, it seems the Ministry is doing well because the revenue envelope

is increasing and debt accumulation is decreasing. If we were able to pay within the first six months more than what was paid the whole of last year, then we are doing well.

My question is, why then is there a need for us to increase the energy sector levies? Why? Because if we have been able to increase the revenue envelope and we are reducing debt, then we are doing well. So, why do we have to burden the taxpayers with GH¢4.50 per gallon? I need a response from the Minister, Mr Speaker.

1.57 p.m.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, it is because of how deep the hole is. The hole is so deep and gaping that when I assumed office, it was very scary.

In fact, we currently have a liability, that is legacy debt, of about GH¢67 billion. Also, as I told the House, a lot of the energy sector Independent Power Producers (IPP) were not receiving even their current bills. So, what we are doing is to improve the current billing and payments. My Colleague, the former Deputy Minister is here, even with this, it still does not pay all the bills. So, we are making progress, but we still need to do a lot more in order to achieve maximum progress.

This year, liquid fuels which is usually not that high, because of increase in consumption, it would total about US\$1.2 billion. So, without this levy, it means that the enormity of the challenge becomes serious. So, we definitely need

that levy to support as we improve and increase gas and get to a level where we need to review, this Government will be willing and ready to undertake the necessary review. Thank you very much.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Collins Adomako-Mensah, the Minister mentioned your name.

Mr Collins Adomako-Mensah: He mentioned it as a friend.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: As a friend? Not to corroborate his answer?

Mr Adomako-Mensah: He mentioned it as a friend.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me listen to Hon Agyinsam first.

Mr Lawrence Agyinsam: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I like the Hon Minister's demeanour as a Minister as compared to when he was in opposition. I think the voice and the tone has come down drastically because of the reality.

My question is this; he said there has been an increase in revenue, may I know from him whether the increase in revenue is due to the fact that there has been increases in terms of tariffs, or is it due to the fact that there has been efficiency or an expansion of the people that are coming to the grid?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, it is a multiplicity of factors. To be frank, in

energy economics, when we increase tariff beyond a certain threshold, we even get less revenue. Because when the tariffs go beyond a certain band, people tend to engage in a lot of illegal connection. So, tariff increment alone does not assure revenue generation. But let me admit that if we have the tariff increment right, it will lead to revenue increment. Also, efficiency and increase in consumption will lead to revenue increment. But I am happy to know that based on all the measures we are putting in place, we are seeing revenue increments. We can do what we call “with and without” and then we can come to that. But it is still early days; at the right time, we will do all the analysis and determine exactly which policy has the maximum impact. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Frank Annoh-Dompreh?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Minister spoke to the Cash Waterfall Mechanism (CWM) which was innovatively brought on board by the previous administration. Yes, — *[Interruption]*— Well, correct me if I am wrong, but that is what I know. Does the Minister intend to sustain it or amend it? Thank you.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, we are reviewing it to enhance it. I have directives from the President himself that we should review it and look at the weights based on the current reality. So, the Cash Waterfall is as good as the revenue that comes into the ports. If the revenue does not come into the ports, we

do not feel the effect of the Cash Waterfall. Mr Speaker, on a lighter note, I am now the Minister, so we should expect that the Minister will be the Minister; so that is it. Thank you very much.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us turn to the Question numbered 134. The Question again stands in the name of Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey.

Outstanding Financial Obligation to Contractors and Suppliers from 2017-2024

Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (NDC — Keta): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the outstanding financial obligation to contractors and suppliers from 2017 – 2024.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Coincidentally, I admitted the Question, so Minister, answer the Question.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, the debt position of the energy sector as at the end of 2024 was US\$3.1 billion. This is made up of State-Owned Enterprises (SOEs) liabilities including those of contractors, suppliers and debt owed IPPs.

So, if we require money to pay contractors, it stands at about US\$3.1 billion, but when we add all suppliers and all obligations, it takes us to GH¢67 billion. Thank you very much.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. No supplementary question. But on

the other one, you said you did not have any supplementary question. You have a supplementary question on this one?

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah — *rose* —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Patrick Boamah, I will come to you. Let me listen to Mr Gakpey.

Mr Gakpey: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I would like to find out from the Minister how he is coping or what strategies are being put in place to address this indebtedness?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, I am happy to announce that yesterday I inaugurated a committee to renegotiate our Power Purchase Agreement (PPAs) and conclude on what the previous administration started.

Also, we have had some discussions with the Minister for Finance where he devoted about GH¢28 billion to pay for energy sector shortfalls. So we are confident these two approaches would help us to address part of what we call the legacy debt. As we continue to improve the sector, we intend to set aside some of the revenues to also amortise and pay off some of these legacy debts. Thank you very much.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Your last one.

Mr Gakpey: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I would like to find out from the Minister, with all this indebtedness, can he assure this House that we will get regular supply of power?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, admittedly, when we assumed office, the power situation was challenging. As I stated on this Floor, in December alone, the deficit was more than 700 megawatts. We have had to take a lot of difficult steps and decisions to get to where we are. I am happy to note that over the past three months, the power situation has been stable, and everybody can attest to that.

Mr Speaker, we still have a lot to do. Some IPPs keep threatening because of their legacy debts. But given the calibre of men we have and the programmes that we are putting in place, I am confident that we would ensure that there is adequate uninterruptible supply of power for economic activity. Thank you very much.

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister in one breath mentioned that our indebtedness stood at US\$3.1 billion; in another breath, he mentioned GH¢67 billion. We all know the legal tender is Ghana cedis. I want to know which exchange rate he used in arriving at the US\$3.1 billion, and whether that is inclusive of the total debt stock in the energy sector. I want some clarity on that.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, the US\$3.1 billion is specific to contractors and suppliers, which means that we are not adding IPPs.

2.07 p.m.

If you look at the exchange rate of US\$1 to GH¢10.5 and looking at our total debt stock in dollars using that

conversion rate comes to the GH¢67 billion. So, for clarity that is the situation.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member for Ofoase Ayirebi.

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah: Mr Speaker, thank you. The Hon Minister mentioned that he is going through a process of renegotiating the power purchasing agreements (PPAs). I want some clarity on that. What percentage of our PPAs outstanding is he renegotiating and is there a timeline by which he expects to be done with that renegotiation?

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister.

Mr J.A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, the previous administration did some work but our instruction is that they should take a comprehensive overview of what has been done so far. If they find some of them or all satisfactory, they proceed.

Also, some PPAs had not been negotiated. So, for instance, we have Karpower, the previous administration could not negotiate it and one or two others. So, their tax comes in two forms. Take a comprehensive overview of what has been done so far. If they need to tweak it, do something about it and deal with it. Then what has not been finalised, try and bring conclusion to that. And the timeline I gave them is that they should be done within one month.

Thank you very much.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, I am making an application for us to vary the Order of Business and hold on with the Questions and take some Motions. Motion itemised as number 14 is a procedural Motion.

Mr Speaker, we need to make some communications to South Africa and we are running out of time so we need to take these Motions to enable the Clerk to make those communications. So, if you will indulge me.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Minority Leadership?

It is obviously a yes.

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): No, I will not oppose.

Mr Speaker, the Motion that the respected Leader is inviting the House to take — Yes, there are some issues. We have seen the Order Paper *Addendum* and I thought that this matter has been dealt with. What is on the Order Paper *Addendum* is not right because we will transition from the main Order Paper to the Order Paper *Addendum* in taking the Motion. Mr Speaker, I respect Leader and I think that for the records I thought the two Leaders would have related and dealt with this matter.

Mr Speaker, if you permit me, if are going by the ratio, 32 per cent, when it is worked out, it will come out to some 1.6 per cent. And in this House, the tradition has always been that we round these

figures up. So, it is as of right. with respect to Leader, it is as of right.

For the Pan-African Parliament, the delegation from our Side is supposed to be two. So, I am constrained a bit because of the fact that we are limited by time. But the right thing has to be done. The Hon Boamah cannot be an observer. It is as of right as a member of the delegation. And I want to plead with our respected Leader. We have had tensed moments in this House before and he has always led us to resolve these matters. So, I plead, let us deal with this matter. It cannot be.

Mr Speaker, it cannot be. I plead with the Leader. Even yesterday, we staged a compromise for them to do their Business. There comes a time that we disagree to agree. Let us do this, Mr Speaker, I beg the Leader in the name of God. As for observer status— I mentioned in the name of God, and the Hon Member is surprised? Mr Speaker, we are constrained, today is the deadline but the Hon Boamah is not an observer. He is not.

In fact, with hindsight benefits, because I have been to the Pan-African several times, my Colleague, the Minister for Roads and Highways, in his other world, when we used to travel together. He came as an observer on a reason because the Hon Muntaka was there and we could not get an understanding. That was how come we coined that word “observer”. So, 32 per cent, we cannot be—Hon Boamah cannot be an observer, He is not. Leader’s case was different. He knows it is different.

So, this Motion cannot be taken unless the matter is resolved. And we must resolve this peacefully and put an end to it.

Mr Speaker, the Leader should let us do it before we can take the Motion.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Leader of the House?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, in all honesty, we have had a lot of back and forth and our Side took a position that out of the delegation of five, we will take four and give the Minority Side, one. And we have held on to these positions and they also demanded that they should be given two and then our Side should hold on to three. We have had a lot of discussions and yesterday, when we met the Speaker, he decided to help us out and said that he will allow us to appoint an additional observer so that the Majority will take the four and the Minority will take two, but one of the Minority Members will be an observer. The Minority Leader approached me severally on the matter and I told him I was going to have a discussion last night and then today I will get back to him. Then when you look at it, now this argument about numbers also applies to the ECOWAS Parliament delegation. So, the ECOWAS Parliament, we have eight representatives and the Majority was insisting on taking six and giving the Minority two. But the Minority was demanding three so the Majority will keep five. Yesterday, after a lot of deliberations last night and looking at the composition and numbers, this morning, I sent a message to my Colleague who

clearly disagreed, but I shared the same message with the Clerk and the Speaker and we looked at the two delegations. When you take the Pan-African Parliament delegation, they are supposed to be five and the Speaker has added one. But when you look at the delegation itself, there is no female Member. The only female Member is coming from our Side and that is Hon Zanetor. And this Hon Zanetor is somebody that the Minority Side has been campaigning for her to be given a position—*[Interruption]*—that Side has been campaigning and campaigning relentlessly. In fact, even yesterday, the Leader was on the Floor campaigning for Hon Zanetor to be recognised and given an allocation.

2.17 p.m.

Now she has been given an opportunity and this Side is against it. They are up in arms against it. When we look at the delegation, there is no female, except Dr Zanetor Agyeman-Rawlings. So, we pleaded that when it comes to the Pan-African Parliament, we should maintain Dr Agyeman-Rawlings, then we could plead with our Brother, Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah to be the observer. Then, the Minority would also be compensated when we go to the ECOWAS Parliament delegation.

So, with the ECOWAS Parliament delegation, the person that we proposed to be part of the Majority delegation would rather also go as an observer, so that the Minority Side would have a delegation of three. So, the three that they are demanding would go for the

ECOWAS Parliament, and then the four we are also demanding would go for the Pan-African Parliament.

In the case of Pan-African Parliament, the Minority Side would send one person as an observer, and we would also send one person as an observer for the ECOWAS Parliament. I thought that was a fair compromise for us. That is what I honestly think.

I honestly want to fully meet my Brother, but this is the situation. We would clearly be breaching the obligation to have a gender representation in our delegation. For Pan-African Parliament, they even have a practice of having observers. I have been in the ECOWAS Parliament, and I honestly do not know of observers in ECOWAS Parliament. It is not there. We do not have observers in ECOWAS Parliament. I have been there for so many years and no delegation comes with an observer. We do not know of observers in ECOWAS Parliament, but out of trying to compromise, the Speaker said we should add someone who would accompany them and observe proceedings, so that when there is an opening in future, then we allow the person to go. So, in effect, what we have done is, we have ceded the ECOWAS Parliament to the Minority Side, and we are also pleading with them so that we can also take the Pan-African Parliament plus an observer.

In fact, our Chief Whip was an observer in the Pan-African Parliament. Yes, he was, because they accept observers. As part of the compromises—We usually make compromises. I am

pleading with the Minority Side; this arrangement works for all of us. Let us accept the arrangement and move the Motion, so that we can have the communication sent to the Pan-African Parliament.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin and Alhaji Muntaka — *rose* —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me hear from the Minority Leader and then I would come to you.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I am very sad this afternoon. Sad in the sense that this Side of the House always keeps to its side of the bargain; but, when it comes to our Colleagues, something different is done. I will take the House through the issues step by step.

Mr Speaker, I got into this House in 2013, and I came to meet a practice where the numerical strength of parties is used to determine composition of Committees and delegations. This practice continued in the Eighth Parliament and now we are in the Ninth Parliament.

Mr Speaker, in the Eighth Parliament, the ratio for ECOWAS Parliament was applied, and it has always been that when the decimal is less than 0.5, that Side goes down; it loses out. If it is more than 0.5, it is rounded up to the next decimal point so that Side would benefit.

Mr Speaker, the ratio as agreed upon in this Ninth Parliament is 32 per cent and 68 per cent. We are 32 per cent and they are 68 per cent. This has been used

to calculate the number of Members representing each Side in the Committees. There are Committees that have 13 National Democratic Congress (NDC) Members and we are just five Members. We have accepted it. It got to a point during the negotiations, I sent my respected Chief Whip to approach our Colleagues that for some of the Committees, we have a 0.45, so they should compromise for us to have one more; they said no. We kept quiet. So, I said it is what it is.

Mr Speaker, we are not striking a compromise on any matter. We are demanding what is our right and this morning, I sent a message to my respected Colleague, the Majority Leader, that I am not pleading.

Yesterday, the Clerk to Parliament invited me, we had a discussion all together. They are saying that the people they proposed are all senior Members, so it is difficult to drop a name because they have already communicated to them, but what about us? Let us not do this to ourselves. If we all agree that there is a formula—

Mr Speaker, about five months ago, I calculated the 32 per cent and circulated it to the Chief Whips, the Majority Leader, and the Speaker. I heard my Colleague mention the name of the Speaker. When we met the Speaker, he saw the calculation and said that that is the formula. We have two for Pan-African Parliament and the Majority Side has three. There is nothing like any observer. There is no compromise, but a matter of right. Let us not do this to ourselves. Let us be fair.

One day—I am not saying the Majority would be going into opposition, but one day; they do not know. We had 169 Members. In less than four years, we came to 137-137. I recall that some of our Colleagues on the other Side, in negotiations, they would tell me what my former boss did when he had the numbers, so they would not compromise. They should not set a precedence that someday, they would be in opposition, and we would also start evoking the same thing, and then they would say we should be fair. Even our Standing Orders provides for the protection of the Minority.

Mr Speaker, we agreed that we were going by the formula. They have their 68 per cent. If they strike the 68 per cent — I would open my phone and share the calculation with the House. We did the mathematics.

[The Hon Member opened his phone and began to calculate]

Mr Speaker, yesterday, I repeated the calculation. Let us start with ECOWAS Parliament. If we calculate, the Majority Side would have 0.68 times 8 and that would be 5.44. The Minority Side would have 0.32 times 8 and that would be 2.56. Per the known formula that we used in the Committee formation, what this means is that with the 5.44, the .44 is not up to 0.5. So, they would keep five. With the 2.56 because we have crossed the 0.5, we round it up to the next decimal point; which makes it three. This is what they have had. In fact, it is the reason we had four-four at the ECOWAS Parliament during the Eighth Parliament. Because when we calculated, we were getting

4.44 and they were getting 3.56, so they said that is what it is. That is why we shared it equally.

Mr Speaker, let us deal with the Pan-African Parliament. In Pan-African Parliament, it is a delegation of five. I calculated and shared it with them. The Majority Side would have 0.68 times 5 which is equal to 3.4 and the Minority Side would have 0.32 times 5 which is equal to 1.6. Using the same formula and the same precedence, they would get three and we would get two. How then do they say that, with respect, the Speaker directed that we should take one and have an observer and they should have four?

Why would we be changing the story as we find convenient? Yesterday, I made it very clear and my respected Colleague, the Leader of Government Business said he was going to consult, and I said there was nothing to consult about. What about all our 3.44?

How many are we on some Committees such as the Independent Constitutional Bodies?

2.27 p.m.

On the Minority Side, we have four. You did not even compromise on some of it that you had about 14. If you check from Public Accounts Committee, how many we do have there? Why did they not compromise on some of those ones for us as Minority? They did not.

Mr Speaker, when it got to the delegation—Currently, there are some

delegations that they have seven and then they gave us one. We do not even know how it is done. There are a lot of travel delegations that this formula does not apply and then they do it as it pleases them. It is not fair. We have Inter-Parliamentary Union (IPU), Commonwealth Parliamentary Association (CPA). I insist that all of these delegations should be laid before Parliament.

We must apply the formula to all the European Union (EU) delegation and every single delegation. Let us lay the Report; we cannot limit it to only Pan-African and ECOWAS Parliaments. We have other delegations and I would plead that we ensure transparency. Our Friends should look at posterity; they should look at tomorrow. They are 183 today, but they should think about tomorrow—*[Interruption]*—Very well; I said 187 with the four independent MPs. That is not a problem. Let me deal with NDC.

The NDC has 183 today—*[Interruption]*—What are you going to say? The 183 and the four independent MPs make 187. The Majority Caucus with the four independent MPs—*[Interruption]*—It is all right. NDC Caucus in this Chamber is 183 and they have some independent Members adding up to their numbers, but they have 183, and not 187. The 187 is the NDC MPs and the independent MPs. So, their Caucus is 187. What is his problem? But the NDC is 183.

Mr Speaker, there is peace in this Chamber. Let us maintain that peace. We are here as a family; even the list that we have on our Side is not conclusive. I was

supposed to do some amendments. I did not know it was going to be advertised. There are some consultations that I did and we need to do some balances here and there. So, we are even not ready as of this afternoon and we need to do some changes because some Members who I consulted expressed some views.

But for Pan-African Parliament, it can go with Hon Boamah and Hon Annoh-Dompreh. With ECOWAS Parliament, we can stay it and deal with the changes. But with Pan-African Parliament, we have two which is as a matter of rights. We are not negotiating; we are not begging anybody and we are not pleading. It is as of rights in accordance with the known precedents that we all know. We have two. It is Hon Patrick Boamah of Okaikwei Central and Hon Annoh-Dompreh of Nsawam/Adoagyiri, the Minority Chief Whip.

Mr Speaker, I am grateful. If they want to do the observer status, that is fine. We will not even ask for observer. We are all right with our two. They can decide to have even three observers. That is up to them.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, just a moment, I have heard everything that he has said. We have all been in this House and I think Hon Muntaka is one of those who understand these things better than any other person. But the reality of the composition of the Pan-African Parliament is this: that it is always led by the First Deputy Speaker, which is non-negotiable. The First Deputy Speaker can be an NPP or NDC Member. It is always led by the

First Deputy Speaker—*[Interruption]*—
Listen to me. I listened to you in silence.

Mr Speaker, the First Deputy Speaker has always led the delegation to the Pan-African Parliament, statutory and we cannot change that. A person can be an NPP, NDC or an independent Member, but he or she leads.

Then the two Chief Whips, the Minority Chief Whip and the Majority Chief Whip, are statutory Members of the delegation. Mr Speaker, when you remove these three, technically, the appointed Members are only two. Now, with two persons to be appointed, let us now apply the percentages and see what they will get and what we will get. That is why when we do the analysis, we said that, for the two nominations, they should take one and then we take one—*[Interruption]*—Well, Hon Muntaka is here. They should go to the records and see: throughout the life of the delegation, it has always been the First Deputy Speaker who leads; then the two Whips and the two nominated people join him. If you look at it from that perspective, it is simple.

So, please, let us allow this arrangement to go on, so that we can have the gender representation. Each of the Sides gets to send one person; then the statutory Members being the Speaker and the Whips will get to go. Indeed, it is pursuant to the position that it has to always be the Whip; that is why when we made a transition in the middle of the life of the Parliament, we had to compromise and allow him to go as an observer because the slot was known to be for the

Whip. That was the position because it was known that the slot is for the Whips. So, even though Hon Muntaka had left as a Whip and was an ordinary Member of the House, we, as a House, agreed that, for a smooth transition, he will go not as a delegation Member but as an observer and this House adopted it.

Mr Speaker, they should not talk as if we want to just use our numbers to oppress them. So, I plead with him: let us allow this arrangement and, indeed, it is to reach out that the Speaker accepted the continuation of the observer status, so that we will have our Colleague, Hon Patrick Boamah, to be a Member of the delegation but as an observer. So, please, I am pleading with him: let us allow this to go. Then, subject to him sorting out his issues with your delegation for the ECOWAS Parliament, we can deal with that one.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, that new theory of statutory membership is unknown. It was the submission of the Majority Leader that the precedent has always been that the two Chief Whips go to Pan-African Parliament; it is not true. Please, let me take him through the history. The Chief Whips have been going to ECOWAS Parliament. It was during my time that Mr Annoh-Dompreh and I said that, because I previously went to ECOWAS Parliament, I would prefer to be in ECOWAS Parliament, instead of going to Pan-African Parliament when I was a Deputy Leader.

So, he decided that he would go to Pan-African Parliament. So, the Majority Leader should not introduce any concept.

In fact, Mr Speaker, he was convinced by somebody in this Chamber. I do not want to bring him into this debate. There is no statutory provision that a First Deputy Speaker should be the one to lead delegation. Let us not create a new— This Harvard jurisprudence that is often being introduced, even when they are in a tight corner, they would now open the Standing Orders and try a certain interpretation for survival.

2.37 p.m.

It would not work this time around, Mr Majority Leader. Now, he is saying, the First Deputy Speaker can be from any party, so that one is aside. Now, there is another statutory: Chief Whip to Chief Whip; that is aside. Anytime I get a case, I will bring him as my lawyer because he knows how to fight to the end. But Counsel, not on this occasion.

The delegation is supposed to be five for Pan-African Parliament and by practice, we always use the numerical strength of both the Majority and Minority for the ratio in this Chamber. We have already agreed on the ratio: 32 per cent to 68 per cent. They have used their 68 per cent to take all the Committees. We did not complain. They never compromise when it was 3.45 for us to get the next, so that we would even have four.

Mr Speaker, just go to the Finance Committee and see, we are just six, out of the whole lot. Public Accounts — *[Interruption]*—That is true. Do not worry. Mr Dafeamekpor has not spoken into the microphone, but I agree with

him. That is the ratio Ghana gave us; I agree. So, why are they taking away what Ghana has given us? What they are trying to — Etse, let us be fair in this game. No, do not try it. We are adults. This game — He knows he is coming to equity with very dirty or unclean hands. Stop it. He knows from his heart. He knows; let us stop this.

Mr Speaker, do not let us introduce and reinvent any theory to back any arguments. They are supposed to be three and we are supposed to be two. Why try to encourage certain actions that will come back and harm this House? We cannot and I do not want Mr Speaker to be introduced into this that he took a decision, please.

We already sat and agreed. When this thing became a controversy, I calculated it. The Clerk to Parliament, the Majority Leader and the Speaker were there; I showed it in his office. His only problem was that he has already informed his senior Members ahead of this. That was it —*[Interruption]*— No, let us be gentlemen.

He said he had already informed them and it would be difficult to go back to say their names had been taken out. He should find another place for them — *[Interruption]*— No, but he has mentioned it. That is why I referred to it. He mentioned it; he listed the names; they are senior Members. Else, I know how to control my mouth. He knows it. He knows what I know, so he should not go there. I am not an okra mouth; he knows —*[Laughter]*— No, I referred to it because the Majority Leader brought it

up. I am not — Yes, of course, I respect code and he knows I respect code.

Mr Speaker, what is happening is unfair. I would plead with the Majority Leader that since his own Chief Whip is saying the 32 per cent is what Ghanaians gave us, he should help us to maintain our 32 per cent. We are not asking for more, irrespective of what they want to do at the Ablekuma North Constituency.

With the news coming up, let us maintain our 32 per cent. Let us have the two for Pan-African Parliament (PAP) and our three for ECOWAS. That is what we are entitled to and we demand it as of right for the umpteenth time. Let me repeat it, we are not going to do any so-called observer and whatever.

Mr Speaker, now, let me come to the next argument. They claim that there was a certain precedence. When there was reshuffle at the Minority Frontbench, Hon Muntaka became naked because there was no role for him at the front seat and they decided to ensure — *[Interruption]*— The naked in this context, please, do not come and contest it. He was no more in the Frontbench and they themselves had an arrangement where they did not want Hon Kwame Gobe Agbodza to go and remove him.

Mr Speaker, I did the same for my boss who was at Inter-Parliamentary Union (IPU). The Clerk to Parliament would bear me out. I said that I do not want to go into all the delegations that he was in because he was the Majority Leader and I told him that, Sir, stay there; I would not even join you as an observer. That was what I did and I stayed back.

Till date, my name is not at IPU. I have decided that I would not go. I will not be at IPU or even Commonwealth Parliamentary Association (CPA). I said I do not want to be part of that one, so that others can go. So, if he compromised to ensure peace in his backyard, he should not now introduce it as a precedence to say that there was an observer status given, so he is doing us a favour by giving us an observer status.

If his Member will not accept an observer status, he should deal with it. We cannot tell Hon Patrick Yaw Boamah that he should go as an observer. Why? Mr Speaker, we are entitled to two out of five. They should take their three and let us have our two. Mr Speaker —

Alhaji Mohammed-Mubarak Muntaka: Mr Speaker, I am very proud and privileged to have been one of the longest-serving Members of this House on the Frontbench and I have also had the privilege and the great honour of serving as Chief Whip at three consecutive times for both Majority and Minority. I will be very grateful if all of us — Not because I am wise or knowledgeable, but at least, I will carry huge experience in handling this and I have handled this at three consecutive times. So, I want to take us into a history of this and I am very optimistic that if our intent is to truly find a compromised position, by the time I am done, we will see our way clearly.

Well, Mr Speaker, let me state that yes, it is true that Chief Whips ordinarily go to ECOWAS. Then we have the Deputy Leaders ordinarily go to Pan-African Parliament. Then we have the

First Deputy Speaker leading the delegation to PAP and I say this with all sincerity, this House is governed by three things: the 1992 Constitution, our Standing Orders, and our practices. Our practices may not be written anywhere; some of them we can find in the *Hansard* or official documents, but it serves as a very useful guide most of the time. Then we have the Leaders who are usually assigned to IPU or CPA.

Something happened in 2013 and I became Chief Whip. Before I became Chief Whip, I had already been assigned as one of the junior Members to Pan-African Parliament before the 2012 election. So, when we came, I remember very well that the then Hon Leader, Mr Osei Kyei-Mensah-Bonsu, encouraged me to move from Pan-African Parliament to where Chief Whips usually go.

I then pleaded with the late Hon Deputy Leader, Mr Agbesi, and said that I have made so much strides in the Pan-African Parliament and I was in some of the very important committees there. So, to leave that and start, I really wish he could swap with me. What I am saying, — the Rt Hon Speaker Doe Adjaho is alive. We went before him and agreed to do the swapping. So, I remained in the Pan-African Parliament, even though I was a Whip and he went to the ECOWAS Parliament.

2.47 p.m.

Now, fast track, in the Eighth Parliament, my Colleague Hon Annoh-Dompreh came, and the Hon Minority

Leader today was the Deputy Leader then. But my situation in 2013 met him, where he was in ECOWAS before becoming the Deputy Leader. I encouraged my Colleague, the Whip, to understand and swap places with him. I want to believe that he had made a lot of strides in ECOWAS, and asking him to change to the Pan-Africa Parliament would mean we would be losing all the advantages that the then Deputy Leader would have gathered in ECOWAS to start afresh. So, they agreed and they swapped and the rest is history. So, it did not start with him; it really started with me.

Mr Speaker, Pan-African Parliament was started in 2004, and our first delegation was led by the current President, Hon Malik Al-Hassan, who is alive, Mr Doe Adjaho, then a Deputy Minority Leader, and Hon Malik Al-Hassan was then the Deputy Speaker. That is why he was the leader of the delegation to the Pan-African Parliament. So, it is not written anywhere, but these are the practices that we have done.

But let me come to the composition. Mr Speaker, in the Sixth Parliament, the total number of the House was 275. The Majority Members were 154, and the Minority were 121. When I talk about this number, I am talking about the caucus because some had independent Members with them. Later, your own neighbour, Hon Osei Owusu, was working with them, and that gave them 121 and we had 154.

Mr Speaker, I want to beg the Leaders to listen to this very carefully,

because I know how emotional it is when things are being shared in this House. When we come from the elections, we have our caucus strength which we normally break into percentages. So back then, we, the Majority, had 56 per cent which was 0.56 and the Minority was 0.44, that was 44 per cent. If we multiply the 0.56, which is that of the Majority, by 13, when I talk about 13—I want all of us to listen very carefully. When I talk about 13, I am talking about five for Pan-Africa and eight for ECOWAS. When we put them together, that is 13.

When we put them together and strike those percentages, it gives the global figure that we get for each caucus. If we look at them, the strength of their caucuses was that with ECOWAS, the Majority was going to have 7.2. When we put the two together, we are going to have 7.2. Members which means seven Members. So, they had three for the Pan-African Parliament and then four. Even though they had 4.47, we wanted to break it. But when we put the two together, it gives 7.2. So, when the percentage does not deviate much from the absolute, we then share three and four.

Then in the Seventh Parliament, the numbers changed and the Majority became 169 and the Minority, 106. When we look at the percentages, it was 0.615 and then 0.38. When we multiply by 13, we were going to get the Majority having 7.99, rounding it up to get eight. And then the Minority was going to have 4.9, rounding it up to five.

The Eighth Parliament is something that all of us can remember very well.

When we came to the Eighth Parliament, the numbers were 138 and 137. With the 138, it came to 0.502 and then 0.49. When we multiply by 13, we were supposed to get about 6.5 each. But this is what happened. In the spirit of compromise, the Majority, in the case of the Pan-African Parliament, even though it was 0.25 each, they took three, and the Minority took two.

Listen to the compromise. Because at all times, when the numbers are splitting, we give it to the Majority because they have more Members than the Minority. So, any time the number is in the middle, we give it to the Majority because they have more Members to cater for. So even though it was 0.25 each, we gave it to the Majority because with the 138, they took three, and with 137, we took two. But this is what we did.

The records of this House are there to show, that is why I am emphasising the Eighth Parliament. When it came to the Committees, we decided to alternate some of the Committees so that if one has an advantage here, *[inaudible]*—to enable the Minority to be carried along. So, when we look at the number allotted for Members on the Subsidiary Legislation Committee, it was 25. We said that because we were chairing it, they should let us have the 13, and they would have 12. And they did that in the spirit of the compromise.

Then we came to the Public Accounts Committee. We did the same. And then I think the Government Assurance Committee as well. So let us look at this Ninth Parliament. If we take the 187 and

the 88, the ratio is 0.68 to 0.32, if we multiply them by 13, it becomes 8.8 for the Majority, and 4.16 for the Minority. So, any attempt to say that we should give two here, and give another three there, is going to take us far away from the absolute percentage. Because we need to work from the absolute percentage before we go to the units. Other than that, it is going to create more distortion.

So, 8.8 means that they have to get nine and 4.1 means they have to get four. But it is there for them to then decide to give two us two in the Pan-African Parliament and two in ECOWAS, so that we will have four. Or no, give us three in ECOWAS because the number there is eight, and give us one in the Pan-African Parliament.

If we move away from this, Mr Speaker, what it simply means is that when it comes to the absolute, we will be disadvantaging the Majority so deep by 0.8 as compared to advantaging the Minority which just has 0.16. So, colleagues, I want to plead with you, if the Speaker had stepped in like he did in the Eighth Parliament, to say that to help manage these difficulties that we have, he wants to give an observer's status. Remember, the last time the compromise came, the observer's status went to the Minority.

So, if the observer's status is coming, it necessarily has to go to the Minority. Colleagues, we can choose to say that all this history I have given is irrelevant because it may not give them what we want. But I want to just caution all of us.

I have heard many of us repeatedly say it.

This House, especially the Leadership, if we do not allow the spirit of compromise to work and also allow the institutional memory or the practice of this House to guide us, what we will simply be doing is that we will always be at war with each other, no matter what is at stake. The way this House has run effectively is that on one leg, a Side gets an advantage, and on the other leg, that Side, gets a disadvantage.

2.57 p.m.

But if we want to say that we must apply the formula for every single Committee, what I know is that, especially with the kind of Majority that we have now, if we are not careful, the Minority will virtually become irrelevant in almost every Committee that we set up. But that may not be good for us. There may be instances where we may have to form a Committee because of what we want them to do, we may say even though we have this —let us compose the Committees in, a kind of 55-45, so that we get it somewhere.

But if we refuse and we want to continue arguing, well, what I would say is that democracy has no alternative. It is the worst form of governance, What I mean by the worst form is that, Mr Speaker is a lawyer, I am an engineer and when it comes to law, and engineering, Mr Speaker is way ahead of me but Mr Speaker and I can go to a contest of engineers and I will be voted and Mr Speaker will be left. Because democracy

says that looking at my face, maybe I look taller than Mr Speaker so they are electing me and leaving Mr Speaker. When Mr Speaker is truly an engineer who could even do the work. But that is what we have. When this becomes a problem, what our rules allow us to do is to vote on them but I will pray that we do not get to a point of voting. Because when we subject everything to vote, what we are doing is that our Colleagues will become irrelevant. But I do not think that will be good for all of us.

I thank you very much for the opportunity to provide this information.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I have heard the long explanation by Alhaji Mubarak Muntaka.

Mr Speaker, there are two important points I want him to note; when we are dealing with the Pan-African Parliament, we are dealing with the Pan-African Parliament. If we are dealing with ECOWAS, we are dealing with ECOWAS. If we are dealing with Commonwealth Parliamentary Association (CPA), we are dealing with CPA. If we are dealing with Inter Parliamentary Union (IPU), we are dealing with IPU. Each of these have their own delegation strength. So, we cannot combine ECOWAS and the Pan-African Parliament and say it is 13; no. I have been a Leader in this House. There was no such thing, so please.

Mr Speaker, I was part of the Seventh and Eighth Parliaments. We dealt with the Pan-African Parliament separately, we dealt with ECOWAS separately, and that is what we know. So as for this new

arrangement, I do not know about it. Let us not go there and try to confuse everybody by saying that we are dealing with a number 13 and striking the average; no. Let us apply 32 just as we do for all the Committees. The Committees in this Parliament are not the same; some Committees are 19, 13, 21 and all.

Mr Speaker, on each Committee, we apply the formula. So the argument he made that we put together and strike the balance is never true. That argument falls flat and having addressed that, I will move to the next.

Mr Speaker, maybe Alhaji Muntaka is not aware, but today, it is good he brought it up. His Colleague, the Majority Chief Whip did not agree to our Side having more numbers for Committees that we chair. The Minority chairs a Committee like Public Accounts Committee; we have 32 per cent on the Committee. I kept quiet for Alhaji Muntaka.

The Members of the Majority Side are not being fair. We agreed from day one and the Majority Chief Whip, said we are here with a strength of 32 per cent. And he said that there was an arrangement where some Committees that we chair, we will have Majority and that is what he thinks should happen to protect the Minority. This was his submission.

Mr Speaker, he is now changing. For me there is nothing to debate. There is really nothing to debate except to see people trying to bully their way. We have

used our 32 per cent to form Committees. On some Committees, we have as low as five. It is the same formula, the same principle. It cannot change when it gets to the Pan-African Parliament or ECOWAS. We will not accept it; we demand it as of right. All these calculations and combinations. Then he should combine all the delegations. CPA and IPU would have their own formula and then we go by the 32 per cent against 68 per cent. Why do they want to change it? No way, they should not do that.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members —

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, let us stand that down. If they are opposed to us moving the procedural Motion, then we will just stand it down. I think we had a challenge with the Clerk to Parliament indicating that he needed to send some communication to South Africa. That is really why we were trying to get this done today. But given the position of Osahen Afenyo-Markin, I think that we will stand it down and engage in some more consultations. I think Alhaji Muntaka has given us some guidance of how it was done in the past. We will discuss that with our Colleagues on the other Side and we will see how we will proceed.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. So we will then move on with our Questions. So we turn to Question 215 standing in the name of Mr Wisdom Cudjoe, MP for Prestea Huni-Valley. Hon Member, you have the floor now.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF ENERGY AND GREEN TRANSITION

When Bepoase, Gambia and other communities in Prestea Huni-Valley would be Captured under the Rural Electrification Programme

Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe (NPP — Prestea Huni-Valley): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition when the following communities will be captured under the Rural Electrification Programme: (i) Bepoase (ii) Gambia (iii) Alhassan (iv) Bayire Agya (v) Nkran Dadieso (vi) Takyie Mantia (vii) Entoada.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Minister for Energy and Green Transition (Mr John Abdulai Jinapor): Mr Speaker, the communities namely, Bepoase, Gambia, Alhassan, Bayire Agya, Nkran Dadieso, Takyie Mantia and Entoada—Mr Speaker, if I may repeat it, “Entoada” —[Laughter]— *ato yen nti, yen ntumi nda*—[Laughter]—

Mr Speaker, they do not form part of the Ministry’s current ongoing electrification project. These communities have been duly noted and will be considered for connection to the national electricity grid in the subsequent phases of the electrification programme when funds become available. We are working with the Minister for Finance to get very positive indication so let me assure my Colleague that it is very possible that within this year, we can capture these communities and start with them.

Mr Cudjoe: Mr Speaker, no other question.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. This Question is constituency-specific, so I would not give anybody the chance for supplementary question. So we turn to Question 216 and the same Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe, Prestea Huni-Valley.

Steps to Resume the Stalled Electrification Works in the Communities

Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe (NPP — Prestea Huni-Valley): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the specific steps the Ministry is taking to resume the stalled electrification works in the following communities within the Prestea Huni Valley Constituency: (i) Subre Nkwanta (ii) Kwasi Kokor (iii) Pewodie (iv) Nazareth (v) Nyamease (vi) Kofikrom (vii) Nyame Bekyere.

3.07 p.m.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister, do not mention— my mind is going back to Mr Agyarko — *[Laughter]*—

Minister for Energy and Green Transition (Mr John Abdulai Jinapor) (MP): The communities, namely Nyamease, Kofi Krom and Nyame Bekyere form part of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition's cost-sharing arrangement under the ongoing Self-Help Electrification Programme. Installation works including High Tension (HT), Low Tension (LT) and substation works have been completed at Nyamease, Kofi Krom and Nyame

Bekyere awaiting customer service connection. The delay in the connection of the communities to the national grid is due to unavailability of energy meters.

The Ministry has initiated procurement processes for some meters and would connect these towns to the grid after taken delivery of same. I want to assure my good Friend and Colleague that once these communities take delivery of these meters, they would be energised.

The Ministry has received the list of prospective customers from the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG) for approval and the release of meters to facilitate the connection of the communities to the national grid.

The Ministry of Energy and Green Transition (MoEnGT) has noted the stalled works in the communities, namely, Subre Nkwanta, Kwasi Kokor, Pewodie and Nazareth. These communities will be considered for connection to the national electricity grid in line with the work programme of the MoEnGT following detailed assessment of the outstanding scope of works.

I would appeal to my Friend that he should let us complete the stalled ones, so that we can apply the materials judiciously. Once we are done with the stalled ones, we can look at the remaining communities and connect them.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Member, do you have any supplementary questions?

Mr Wisdom Robert Cudjoe: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the second batch of communities mentioned here, Kwasi Kokor, Pewodie, Subure Nkwanta, also had part of the project completed as far back as 2016. They formed part of the second batch of rural electrification from 2012 to 2016. The Minister is talking about doing detailed assessments of the outstanding scope of work. Mr Speaker, at that time, we installed all the poles and laid the cables. We were just about to connect them to the National Grid when NDC exited power and that was the end of the programme. The other adjoining communities, like Broni Nkwanta and Effukey have light. So, it is a matter of connecting these communities also to the National Grid. And I would plead with the Minister; the assessment is that everything is set. We are waiting for them to be connected to the National Grid.

Thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, did you get the question?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, with your permission, may I appeal to my Colleague that tomorrow, if it suits him, at 9.30 a.m., I will have a meeting with him, so we can clear this issue. Mr Speaker, I just want to appeal to him. I will be available for him tomorrow at 9.30 a.m.

Thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

We now turn to Question 145, standing in the name of Hon Kwadwo Damoah, Member for Jaman South.

Steps to Address the Loopholes in the Inventory Management System of ECG

Col Kwadwo Damoah (NPP — Jaman South): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the steps the Ministry is taking to address the loopholes in the inventory management system of the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG), to prevent such discrepancies in the future, following the report of 27th May, 2025 regarding the recovery of the Two Thousand, Six Hundred and Thirty-Seven (2,637) ECG containers at the Tema Port while fifty-four (54) containers remain unaccounted for and provide an update on the status of the 54 missing containers

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, let me thank my Colleague for bringing this very important issue up.

Let me state that the ECG Management has operationalised and mandated the use of its Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) system to integrate and streamline its core business

processes, including procurement and inventory management processes. The Materials Management Module of the “Systems, Applications, and Products (SAP) in Data Processing” system is currently fully operational and all processes in inventory management are being managed through the SAP system. Since the use of the SAP was mandated in March 2025, following my instruction, no major loopholes have been identified in inventory management.

Although the Question alleged that 54 containers were missing, it is important to clarify that only 23 containers out of the list of 2,637 ECG submitted to Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority (GPHA) could not be verified through the Integrated Customs Management System (ICUMS). ECG is currently working with GPHA and the Ministry of Energy & Green Transition to trace the whereabouts of these containers.

To also add, we have directed ECG to cease all such procurements and ensure that they procure critical items that they require and also budget to clear those containers and not leave them at the Port to the mercy of such numbers that he has mentioned as missing containers.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Col Damoah, any supplementary question?

Col Damoah: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I am happy he said that the number of missing containers is no longer 54, but 23; 23 is still substantial in port management system.

I want to ask the Minister, how are containers transferred to terminals and what records show the locations of containers at the ports such that we still have missing containers.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, the first point is that those containers should not have been purchased in the first instance. That is the first answer to the question of missing containers—*[Interruption]*. Those containers should not have been purchased.

Mr Speaker, the second thing—Like he said, his question is direct, how are containers transported? It was poorly transported. That was why in March 2025, we decided that we would not adopt that approach again. So having adopted this SAP system since March 2025, we are now seeing a remarkable improvement in how the containers are handled.

Thank you very much.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us turn to Question 212—

Col Damoah: Mr Speaker, my last supplementary question.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Damoah, let us hear you.

Col Damoah: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I want to ask the Hon Minister, is it possible for a container to be in a location at the terminal without records showing exactly where that container is?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minister?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, I do not work at the port; I am not a port official. I can only hazard that without proper record-keeping, without improved systems in place like we have put in place since March. What the Hon Member is saying is very possible. But let me assure my Colleague that with what we have done so far, based on my directive as the Minister for the sector, that will not happen. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Minister—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I thought Hon John Jinapor is your Friend.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: He is my Friend, but I am trying to extract a good response from him—*[Interruption]*.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: His questions are too difficult.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, he is capable; the Minister is capable. He says he does not work at the port. Of course, we know he does not work at the

port. I find that not to be a very satisfactory answer. Maybe the Minister should say that he should be given some time to do some consultation. But when he says he does not work at the port, we know he does not work at the port. Maybe, the Minister could have proffered some better answers. But that is just by the way; I will end it here.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, he wanted my opinion. He was not asking me to go and get figures. I said I cannot proffer that opinion because that is not my area of expertise. We know that all of us have our area of expertise.

But if that offends him, I withdraw it.

Thank you.

3.17 p.m.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: To request for an opinion is an offence to our Rules. I did not notice that; if it was a case that he was asking for an opinion, then it offends the Rules. The Hon Minister is right, but I hope he does his work well.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us turn to the Question numbered 212.

Hon Damoah, your Questions are difficult — All right, let me give you the last chance.

Col Damoah: Mr Speaker, the first supplementary question had two legs. The second leg would have catered for that, but he did not answer that. The first supplementary question was: how are

containers transferred to terminals and what records show the locations? Because he did not answer that question, I asked if it is possible for containers to be at locations, terminals, and the ports and there would not be any records on them. Because I know that it is not possible. For every container that leaves a ship, there must be records on the exact location of that container.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Damoah, I think he answered it, so let us move on. Hon Elvis Osei Mensah Dapaah is eager to ask his Question.

So, Hon Elvis Dapaah Osei Mensah, Member of Parliament for Ahafo Ano South West, you have the floor now. You may ask your Question numbered 212.

Progress of Installation of Transformers in Achiase, Kunsu and Mankranso

Mr Elvis Dapaah Osei Mensah (NPP — Ahafo Ano South West): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the progress of the installation of transformers in the following communities in the Ahafo Ano Constituency: (i) Achiase (ii) Kunsu (iii) Mankranso.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, the Achiase community forms part of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition's ongoing electrification projects in the Ahafo Ano South West District of the Ashanti Region under the Self-Help Electrification Programme (SHEP).

Following the completion of High Voltage (HV) and Low Voltage (LV) works in 2024, 33/0.433kV, 100kVA 3-Ph transformer was released for installation and commissioning in the Achiase community. Our understanding is that the transformer which was installed in the Achiase community has since developed a fault. The consultant of the Ministry for SHEP projects in the area is currently working with the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG), Ashanti West office, to help address the issue. ECG has been directed and is expected to conduct an assessment of the faulty transformer and advise the Ministry on same towards restoration of electricity supply in the community.

I expect that information this week. Once I get that information this week, if it means replacing that transformer, Mr Speaker, I will work with my Hon Colleague and ensure that we replace the transformer.

The other two (2) communities namely, Kunsu and Mankranso do not form part of the ongoing electrification project of the Ministry. It is noted that these two communities are already connected to the national electricity grid. Change of transformers and any maintenance works on the networks in these communities are expected to be undertaken by the utility company, Electricity Company of Ghana, in the district.

I take note of these two communities and assure my Hon Colleague that we would capture them based on the earlier assurance I gave with the work we are doing with the Minister for Finance.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Dapaah, any supplementary questions?

Mr Dapaah: Yes, Mr Speaker.

I would like to ask again about the shortage of meters in the following communities, Assibey-Nkwanta, Dunyankwanta, Achiase, Kunsu Dotiem *et cetera*. How is the Minister addressing this, so that, at least, I can get meters to these particular communities?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: I want to plead with my Colleagues that we will not hand the meters to them to be given to the people in their constituencies, but we will work with them to address that challenge. So, he should be assured. Tomorrow, at 9.30 a.m., I have a meeting with my Colleague, so if it would not worry the Hon Member, he may join the 9.30 a.m. meeting, so that both of us will sit and resolve the issues.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members on that note —

Hon Member, do you still have a supplementary question? I thought you were going to meet him, so that you deal with him. Do you want to ask the question?

Mr Dapaah: There is something here that I am contemplating. The Hon Minister said transformers were sent to Achiase and other communities. I have the contact of the contractor and I have been dealing with him. This was what happened. I bought a transformer for the Achiase community with my own pocket money, Mr Speaker. So I just want to be

sure how the Ministry sent a transformer to Achiase and I have no idea.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think it is fundamental—He bought his own transformer and the Minister said he also sent a transformer to the community.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, I am happy that this has come up because the records I received in the handing over notes revealed that the Ministry sent that transformer in 2024. I am happy the Hon Member is drawing my attention that, contrary to what the Ministry provided me with, he rather bought the transformer. So, Mr Speaker, with your permission once again, tomorrow, when we meet, we will clear all these issues and bring clarity to all.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Members—

Mr Dapaah: Mr Speaker, I just want to thank the Hon Minister for his response.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: He wants to thank you —

Mr Annoh-Dompreh — *rose* —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Leader, let me discharge him first. Hon Members, on behalf of the entire House —

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: The Minister has another Business, but I see the Minister for Roads and Highways and the Minister for the Interior are here. The

Minister for the Interior has a briefing to offer to this House.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I am just discharging him from —

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Yes, but I am reminding him; he should not leave the Chamber. He has a Statement to make. He has not seen it. He should look at the item numbered 8 on page 5. The Minister for the Interior and he are there. But the Minister for Roads and Highways can be ushered in now; he has been sitting for a very long time. Otherwise, Mr Speaker, your road will be a “suspect”. You may have to allow him to answer the Questions.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Minister for Energy and Green Transition — anyway, you just got out of the chair — We thank you for attending upon the House. You are discharged.

Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we want to crave your indulgence to allow the Minister for the Interior to brief the House on the matter that we requested him to come and brief us on. There are some urgent security matters elsewhere he needs to deal with. So, if the Minister can come and make his Statement —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Members, we are still dealing with today’s programme. So, turn to page 5, Statements, and the item numbered 8, which deals with the Minister for the Interior, as well as Minister for Energy and Green Transition, to address the House.

Yes, Hon Member for Asawase?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, even though my respected Majority Leader said that — he just made a comment not to the microphone but I picked it — the Minister for Energy and Green Transition has no locus and was signalling him to exit the Chamber.

If the Majority Chief Whip would recall, the day the Statement was made, he actually called for the Minister for Energy and Green Transition because of his wherewithal. So, I suggested the Ministry of Transport and he said that we should go for the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition. Does he remember? It is captured as such: Minister for the Interior and Minister for Energy and Green Transition —*[Interruption]*— It does not lie in the mouth of the Majority Chief Whip to do that.

3.27 p.m.

He should seek the leave of the House. With respect to the Leader, he cannot veto and say that he is amending it. He should seek the leave of the House or the Speaker, then we can change it. He knows I am not a difficult person; I am not difficult.

So, Leader, say it into the microphone for the records—*[Interruption]*—Yes, I know, but for the records, so that we can usher Hon John Abdulai Jinapor out.

[Mr John Abdulai Jinapor bowed and attempted to exit the Chamber]

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: No, I am not ushering you out—[Laughter]—I do not have the power. I am saying that the Leader should say to the records that the Minister for the Interior will do it, then the Minister can exit.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think it was a mistake to have summoned the Minister for Energy and Green Transition to come and answer a Question about that. So, with your indulgence, we can let the Minister go and the Minister for the Interior will be able to brief us.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I support the Majority Leader, but this is just to add that it is not a mistake. The Table have done their work well. It was actually a call by the Majority Chief Whip.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that day you were in the seat—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I was chairing, yes.

Mr Dafeamekpor: So, the sentiments were mainly about going forward, how do we protect the crossings? So, we were looking at provision of life jackets. So, it became a matter of budget. It is about money; that is why we said, then the Ministries of the Interior, and Energy and Green Transition could come together and get some budget to provide the life jackets. But the Minister for the Interior is here, so we could present the briefing on behalf of both Ministries.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Yes, Hon Member for Asawase, the Minister for the Interior and the Minister responsible for National Security.

STATEMENT

Drowning of Seven Students of Lawra Senior High School

Minister for the Interior (Alhaji Mohammed-Mubarak Muntaka) (MP): Mr Speaker, on Saturday, 14th June, 2025, at around 0913 hours, the Headmaster of Lawra Senior High School, Mr Primus Bero, reported to the Lawra Police Command—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, hold on.

Is the Hon Bede Ziedeng here?

Alhaji Muntaka: Yes, he is here.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. I am happy you are here because it was your Statement that actually—Minister, you may go on.

Alhaji Muntaka: Reported to the Lawra Police Command on telephone that Lawra Senior High School cadet comprising 16 students led by—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, kindly permit me to call the First Deputy Speaker to take the seat.

You may go on, Minister.

3.32 p.m. — [MR FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER IN THE CHAIR]

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, Mr Primus Bero reported to the Lawra Police Command on telephone that Lawra Senior High School cadet comprising 16 students led by a cadet leader went jogging along the Lawra-Dikpe Road. The cadet leader later called to inform the headmaster that on reaching the Dikpe River, that is the Black Volta, 10 of the students, in the process of crossing the river to the Burkina Faso side and back with a canoe being paddled by a young man they encountered, the canoe capsized midstream which led to seven students drowning, with only three surviving.

Mr Speaker, the police team, led by the District Commander, immediately proceeded to the scene and joined the Dikpe community in organising a search party under the Leadership of the chief of Dikpe. The search party managed to recover the bodies of the students, which have subsequently been released to their families for burial.

Mr Speaker, the Regional Security Council (REGSEC), through coordinated efforts with all relevant agencies, have put in place the following measures:

1. Regular sensitisation of canoe owners, operators and residents along the Black Volta Basin.
2. Sensitisation of students and identifiable bodies on maritime safety.

3. The Ghana Maritime Authority has provided life jackets to canoe operators along the river.
4. The Ghana Maritime Authority to conduct regular monitoring of the canoe operators to ensure that they use these life jackets that are given them for the safety of users on the river.
5. Ensure all canoes are regularly maintained.
6. Provide psychosocial assistance to students of the Lawra Senior High, especially the three that survived.

Mr Speaker, it is expected that these measures put in place by the Upper West Regional Security Council will avert the future occurrence of this unfortunate incident that has taken the lives of these future leaders.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you so much.

Yes, by agreement.

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, let me thank my Colleague and Friend for paying attention and responding to the need for his outfit to come and brief and apprise the House on such matters. I see my Colleague, Hon Bede Ziedeng, who raised the matter showing his solidarity to the family and the constituency.

I am happy the Minister has walked us through the statistics, the fatalities and the measures put in place to track and deal with these matters. I concede that it is a good effort, but I wonder what the role of the Minister for Transport would be in this context. I am under the impression that the canoes that move on these water bodies are under the purview of the Minister for Transport. Of course, there are security angles to it, which he has handled well.

I commend my Colleague, the Minister, but I will urge him to relate to the Minister for Transport. I am sure they will have professionals who can also help in the work they do on these water bodies.

Having said this, our hearts go out there to the affected victims and their families. I would also like to urge the Minister to work closely with adjoining constituencies and the Member of Parliament who was affected, so that the families could be assisted in these difficult times.

Mr Speaker, having said this, I commend my Minister for paying heed to the call and wish the family my deepest condolences.

Mr Speaker, I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, luckily, the maker of the Statement is on the Floor, so if he has a few words to share in respect of the Statement;

otherwise, we have no comment because the comments have been made.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Bede Anwataazumo Ziedeng?

Mr Bede Anwataazumo Ziedeng (NDC — Lawra): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to make some comments on the Statement which have been made by the Hon Minister for the Interior. Let me start by thanking him for coming to brief the House as to what his Ministry and the other agencies are doing to ameliorate the difficulties that the people are going through.

Mr Speaker, that incident is, indeed, a very sad situation for us and Lawra was not comfortable when that incident happened. There was serious mourning in Lawra, both in the school and the town. But with time, they have been able to overcome that difficulty.

When the incident happened, besides the Statement I made in this House, I also took other steps to ensure that the situation was brought under control. I first went to the National Disaster Management Organisation (NADMO) and informed the Director-General about the incident and appealed to him to try to provide life jackets for communities along the Black Volta and he agreed that he would try to do so, but, immediately, he did not have life jackets to provide to those communities. I then moved to the Ghana Maritime Authority and informed the Director General about the situation in Lawra. Again, he agreed that he was

going to provide the life jackets immediately.

3.37 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I can report to you that the Director-General of the Ghana Maritime Authority has visited Lawra with his team, and they have made the following donations to the people of Lawra, and in particular, Dikpe. They have provided five communities with life jackets. Each community has a number of life jackets that they will use throughout the period. There are five communities, so each one will get six life jackets, and they are supposed to use the life jackets when they are travelling on the boats.

For the bereaved families, they tried to provide them with a little support. Each bereaved family got five bags of 50-kilogramme rice and GH¢5,000.

There were three students who survived, and they gave them GH¢2,000 each. It went to the students themselves because they are alive, but the GH¢5,000 went to each bereaved family. We also realised that one of the reasons the accident happened was because the canoe which was used is a wooden canoe, and it is an old canoe which can easily leak. So, I discussed with the Director-General of the Ghana Maritime Authority as to whether it is not possible to have some metal canoes, so that there is no opportunity for any water to leak into the canoe. I think that he has considered that particular proposal, and they will be working on it.

Finally, Mr Speaker, the Ghana Maritime Authority has also agreed, going forward, to provide what they call Marine Guards in all the communities which run along the Black Volta, and these Marine Guards would be stationed there, whether two or three, and they will be there all the time. They will provide guidance to all people who are commuting between the two countries and ensure that proper protocols are upheld when they are using the canoes. So, I think that is a very good measure that will be put in place, and if it is done, I am sure that it will reduce the incidence of these accidents.

Mr Speaker, I think so far, this is what we have done—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you may conclude.

Mr Ziedeng: Mr Speaker, I think so far, we have tried to comfort the bereaved families. We have visited them and delegations have visited them, and fortunately for us, they have been able to perform funeral rites all of them. The other three are still recuperating in the school.

With these few words, Mr Speaker, I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, some Questions are scheduled to be responded to by the Hon Minister responsible for Roads and Highways. He is here. May he take a seat and respond to those questions. Starting with the

Urgent Questions. Item numbered 6(b), standing in the name of Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey, Member of Parliament for Yilo Krobo. Hon Member, you have the floor.

URGENT QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF ROADS AND HIGHWAYS

Resumption and Completion of Otekpulu Bridge in Yilo Krobo

Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (NDC — Yilo Krobo): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways, when work on the construction of the Otekpulu bridge in the Yilo Krobo constituency will resume and be completed?

Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza) (MP): Mr Speaker, the Otekpulu bridge links Otekpulu Township, Somanya, Krobo Odumasi and beyond. It is located in the Yilo Krobo Municipality of the Eastern Region. The said bridge is part of the 50 bridges being constructed by the Ghana Government through a €47 million facility agreed between the Government of Ghana and the Czech Republic. Work started on 3rd March, 2021 and it was to be completed by 3rd March, 2022.

Works executed to date: One number abutment at Otekpulu site and central pier completed. Excavation of foundation of abutment at Odumase side and

progress of work is 40 per cent physical completion. The contractor has suspended works due to the debt restructuring programme. Efforts are being made to get the contractor return to site and complete the works.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?
Dr Nyakotey: Mr Speaker, I want to ask the Minister if the construction of the Otekpulu bridge would resume by the end of the year, because I did not get the exact date that he mentioned.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I did not say it will start by the end of the year. I said the project got suspended because of the debt restructuring. Efforts are being made to get the contractor to site. As soon as that is completed, the contractor will resume work and complete the project.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further questions?

Dr Nyakotey: No further questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this is a constituency-specific question. Let us move to the Question numbered 6(c), standing in the name of Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe, Member of Parliament for Prestea Huni-Valley.

Current State of the Bogoso-Prestea Road

Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe (NDC — Prestea Huni-Valley): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and

Highways the current state of the Bogoso-Prestea Road.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, the Bogoso-Prestea Road, 28.7 km, is one of the critical components of the Western Regional Trunk Road Network, and it is strategically located within the Prestea Huni-Valley Municipality of Western Region. The road forms part of the Regional Route, R121. The current programme is that the road has been awarded under the contract titled “Reconstruction of Bogoso-Prestea Road, 18.7 km and Critical Road Access, 10km.” Work commenced on 24th April, 2025, for completion by 24th April, 2027. The contractor is currently mobilising to site.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary questions?

Mr Cudjoe: Mr Speaker, I have not seen the contractor yet, but I believe this response is a little bit heartwarming as compared to the previous responses that I have received for the same road on the same question. I believe the Minister will translate his words into action. I thank him for awarding this contract and the assurance given to the people. I am sure this will be a breaking news to the good people of Prestea Huni-Valley.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Question numbered 185 standing in the name of Mr Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF ROADS AND HIGHWAYS

Plans for the Wundua, Langbinsi, Kasape, Busulungu, Timpela Road

Mr Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni (NDC — Nalerigu/Gambaga): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the plans the Ministry has in respect of the Wundua, Langbinsi, Kasape, Busulungu, Timpela roads.

Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza) (MP): Mr Speaker, the project Yendi to Sakpiegu road is a national—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, it seems I jumped a Question. There is one Question on page three before page four—

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, is it not Question 184?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, Question 185.

Mr Agbodza: Question numbered 185?

3.47 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I would come to Question numbered 184.

Mr Agbodza: A) “Upgrading of Sakpiegu – Chereponi Road (KM 0 – 50)”.

The contract was awarded on 5th July, 2016 and commenced on 15th August, 2016 for completion by 15th August, 2019. The completion date was extended to 14th August, 2022 which has since elapsed. The physical progress achieved is 25 per cent. The Contractor has suspended works due to delay in payment for work done.

B) “Upgrading of Sakpiegu – Chereponi Road (KM 50 – 100)”

Alhaji Mumuni: This is an answer to Question 184. You are supposed to be answering 185.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, if this will create a confusion, let me give the floor to Mr Alajor Alhassan Seidu, Hon Member for Chereponi?

Completion of Yendi-Chereponi-Yorku, Saboba-Chereponi and Chereponi-Gbintiri Roads in the Chereponi Constituency

Mr Seidu Alhassan Alajor (NDC — Chereponi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the following projects in the Chereponi Constituency would be completed: (i) Yendi-Chereponi-Yorku (ii) Saboba -Chereponi (iii) Chereponi-Gbintiri.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, this is Question numbered 184.

Mr Kwame Governs Agbodza: Mr Speaker, thank you for rearranging the Questions.

Yendi – Chereponi - Yorku Road (Sakpiegu – Chereponi - Yawgu KM 0.0 – 100.0):

Background

The Yendi to Sakpiegu road is a National Road with Route Number N-002 in the Northern Region. Sakpiegu to Chereponi road N14 branches off the Eastern Corridor Road (N-002) to Chereponi District and Yawgu at the North-East Region – Togo boundary. Additionally, it connects Yendi, Saboba, Zabzugu and Tatale to Chereponi and the towns beyond. The section from Yendi – Sakpiegu is an asphaltic road in good condition. The current surface condition of the Sakpiegu – Yawgu road is as follows;

- Km 0-26 – fair
- Km 26-50 – poor
- Km 50-65 – fair
- Km 65-75 – good
- Km 75-100 – poor

Current Programme

The road has been awarded under two different contracts with the following contract titles: A) “Upgrading of Sakpiegu – Chereponi Road (KM 0 – 50)” and B) “Upgrading of Sakpiegu – Chereponi Road (KM 50 – 100)”.

A) “Upgrading of Sakpiegu – Chereponi Road (KM 0 – 50)”

The contract was awarded on 5th July, 2016 and commenced on 15th August, 2016 for completion by 15th August, 2019. The completion date was extended to 14th August, 2022 which has since elapsed.

The physical progress achieved is 25 per cent.

The Contractor has suspended works due to delay in payment for work done.

B) “Upgrading of Sakpiegu – Chereponi Road (KM 50 – 100)”

The contract was awarded on 5th July, 2016 and commenced on 24th November, 2016 for completion by 23rd August, 2019. The completion date was extended to 20th September, 2025.

The physical progress achieved is 44.03 per cent.

The Contractor has suspended works due to delay in payment for work done.

Sabuba (Saboba) - Chereponi Road**Background**

The Saboba – Chereponi road is a Regional Road with Route Number R-204 in the Northern Region. It connects the Saboba District in the Northern Region to the Chereponi District in the North-East Region. Additionally, it is an alternative route to the Eastern Corridor Road for commuters travelling from

Yendi, Zabzugu and Tatale to Chereponi and the towns beyond.

Current Programme

The road has been awarded under the contract titled “Rehabilitation (Unpaved) of Saboba – Chereponi Road (km 0 – 47)”.

The project was awarded on 30th June, 2015. The contract commenced on 25th January, 2016 for completion by 25th January, 2018.

The physical progress achieved is 55 per cent.

The Contractor has abandoned site due to delay in payment for work done. Efforts are being made for works to resume.

Chereponi-Gbintiri Road**Background**

The Chereponi-Gbintiri Road (50.3 km) is an unengineered road in poor condition. The road is in the Chereponi District of the North East Region.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering studies have been undertaken and cost estimates submitted for consideration.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further question?

Mr Alajor: Yes, Mr Speaker. Let me lay a foundation for my follow-up question. I know the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways is a very fine and hardworking gentleman. The President is also interested in completion of the road between Chereponi and Yendi and that of other roads in Chereponi.

Mr Speaker, I know very well that as we speak, thousands of people in Chereponi are watching the Hon Minister live, trying to know the timeline for the completion of the road. Several of my predecessors have asked the same question here. Can you please tell me the timeline for the completion of these roads? Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, what is the timeline for the completion of those roads?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I clearly understand the feelings of our Colleague on the need to get this project completed since it was awarded in 2016. I have already said that we have completed the engineering studies and efforts are being made to get this done. I have already said in the first part of my Answer that part of the reason that even the ones that are on contract have been suspended is frankly because Government is unable to pay for works done. So yes, I agree with him that we will work hard to make sure we award the rest of the work, but I am unable to say specifically when that will be done because we just completed the

engineering studies and costing. So, we shall programme this for actual work in due course. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further question?

Mr Alajor: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I have another Question, Question numbered 190.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, we will get to Question numbered 190, then on that note, I will give the floor to Mr Mumuni Muhammed Nurideen, Question numbered 185.

Plans of the Ministry in respect of the Wundua – Langbinsi – Kasape – Busulungu – Timpela roads

Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni (NPP — Nalerigu/Gambaga): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the plans the Ministry has in respect of the Wundua – Langbinsi – Kasape – Busulungu – Timpela roads.

Mr Agbodza: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Wundua - Langbinsi – Kasape – Busulungu – Timpela roads

Background

The Wundua - Langbinsi – Kasape – Busulungu – Timpela road is 40.5km long. It is a partially engineered gravel road in poor surface condition. It is located in the East Mamprusi District of the North East region.

Current Programme

The Wundua - Langbinsi – Kasape – Busulungu – Timpela road was awarded under the contract titled “Upgrading to bituminous surfacing of Wulugu-Langbinsi-Wondua Feeder Road (40.50km)”.

The contractor commenced on 19th February, 2025 for completion by 20th February, 2027. The Contractor is mobilising to site to commence the works.

The contractor is mobilising to site to commence work.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further question?

Alhaji Mumuni: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I would like to find out from the Hon Minister the contractor working on the road?

3.57 p.m.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I need to come back to my Colleague with specifics about details of the contractor.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, any further questions?

Alhaji Mumuni: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. Hon Minister, I will follow up to get the name of the contractor, so that I will know how to liaise with him and see what will happen.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us move to the Question

numbered 186, also standing in the name of Hon Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni.

The Status of Gambaga to Tamboku Roads

Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni (NPP— Nalerigu/Gambaga): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways, the status of the Gambaga — Nanori — Tinsungu — Latarigu — Dagbiriboari — Tamboku roads.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Agbodza: Gambaga – Nanori – Tinsungu – Latarigu – Dagbiriboari – Tamboku roads.

Background

The Gambaga – Nanori – Tinsungu – Latarigu – Dagbiriboari – Tamboku road is 23.1km long. It is located in the East Mamprusi District of the North East Region. The first 1.3km of the road has been upgraded to asphaltic surface, which is in good condition. The remaining length is gravel/earth surface in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

The remaining section of the road has been divided into four (4) phases and awarded under four (4) separate contracts as follows:

- a) Phase 1: Upgrading of Gambaga – Tambogo Feeder Road (km 1.3 – 6.0)
- b) Phase 2: Upgrading of Gambaga – Tambogo Feeder Road (km 6.0 – 11.0)
- c) Phase 3: Upgrading of Gambaga – Tambogo Feeder Road (km 11.0 – 16.0)
- d) Phase 4: Upgrading of Gambaga – Tambogo Feeder Road (km 16.0 – 23.1)
- (a) Phase 1: Upgrading of Gambaga – Tambogo Feeder Road (km 1.3 – 6.0)

The road was awarded under the contract titled “Upgrading of Gambaga – Tambogo Feeder Road Ph. 1 (km 1.3 – 6.0)”.

The contract was awarded on 22nd December, 2020 for completion by 19th May, 2022. The progress of works is estimated at 15 per cent physical completion. The contract has been terminated due to non-performance by the contractor.

- (b) Phase 2: Upgrading of Gambaga – Tambogo Feeder Road (km 6.0 – 11.0)
- (c) Phase 3: Upgrading of Gambaga – Tambogo Feeder Road (km 11.0 – 16.0)
- (d) Phase 4: Upgrading of Gambaga – Tambogo Feeder Road (km 16.0 – 23.1)

The above contracts (b, c, d) were awarded on 22nd December, 2020 for completion by 19th May, 2022. The contracts have been terminated due to non-performance by the contractor.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Alhaji Mumuni: Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Minister, when the people of Nalerigu/Gambaga Constituency should expect the terminated project to be re-awarded to a different contractor?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, once it has been terminated, the process of reassessment needs to be carried out and once that is completed, it will be scheduled for a new award. I am unable to give the exact date for which the new contractor will be selected and asked to go to site, but I sympathise with the Hon Member. If a contractor has been awarded a project in the backyard of the then Vice President, and that contractor underperforms in that manner, I wonder what kind of punishment the contractor deserves. But I agree that it is something that is very unfortunate. Four different lots of projects, and the contractor who was selected just could not do anything. All the contractor did was to clear the site and leave the site. That is unacceptable, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further questions? Yes, Hon Member?

Alhaji Mumuni: I want to thank the Minister and to tell him that the people of Nalerigu/Gambaga Constituency are in his hands.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. The Question numbered 188, Hon Alhassan Umar, Member of Parliament for Zabzugu?

Hon Members, he is not here.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I would humbly request that the Answers as provided for Questions 188 be captured in the *Hansard* as having been answered when I was here, though the Hon Member was not here to ask the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Can we move to the Question numbered 190, standing in the name of Hon Seidu Alhassan Alajor, Member of Parliament for Chereponi.

When the Construction of Wonjuga-Wenchiki Road will Commence

Mr Seidu Alhassan Alajor (NDC—Chereponi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of the Wonjuga-Wenchiki road will commence.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

Wonjuga (Wanjaga) -Wenchiki

Background

The Wanjaga-Wenchiki Road is an unengineered road in poor condition. The road is in the Chereponi District of the North East Region.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering studies have been undertaken and cost estimates have been submitted for consideration. As soon as funds become available, we will programme this road for commencement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any follow-ups?

Mr Alajor: Yes, Mr Speaker. I heard the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways saying there is no programme on this road for now and engineering studies has been done on the road.

Mr Speaker, I would like to ask the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways, since there is no programme on this road, when should the people of Chereponi expect a programme on this road? Because this road is very critical to —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, Hon Minister, when should they expect a programme on the road?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, the good thing is that we have already carried out

engineering studies and costing. So, it is just a matter of getting approval of the funding and then we can start. So as quickly as possible, we would start this. I want to assure my Colleague and his constituents that we are committed to making sure that some of these problems we see across the country are addressed and we will work with him to make sure that we address this.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any other questions?

Mr Alajor: Mr Speaker, thank you so much. This is not a question, but I want to make a passionate appeal. The Minister for Roads —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you can see the Minister thereafter. Thank you very much.

Let us proceed to the Question numbered 201, standing in the name of Hon Collins Adomako-Mensah, Afigya Kwabre North.

When the Network from Nkwantakese to Esaase will be Completed

Mr Collins Adomako-Mensah (NPP — Afigya Kwabre North): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the road network from Akon through the following communities will be completed: (i) Nkwantakese (ii) Penteng (iii) Pampatia (iv) Patase to (iv) Esaase.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

(i) Akon (Akom) – Kodie

Background

The Akom, Nkwantakese, Penteng, Pampatia, Patase and Esaase are all towns located along the Akom – Kodie feeder road (11.35km) in the Afigya Kwabre North District in the Ashanti region. It is an engineered road in poor condition that connects to the Techiman-Tamale highway.

Previous contracts awarded on the road were terminated in May 2024 for non-performance by the contractors.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies will be carried out by the end of the fourth quarter of 2025 to assess the appropriate intervention after which consideration would be made under the 2026 Budget.

4.07 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary?

Mr Adomako-Mensah: In the Answer of the Minister, he acknowledged that the road is in bad condition, but I am comforted by the fact that he said

engineering work would be done in the fourth quarter. I just want to plead with him that, just as he has acknowledged that it is in very poor condition, he should quicken the pace, so that my constituents will be comfortable.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We now move to the Question numbered 202, standing in the name of Hon Gloria Owusu, Member of Parliament for Trobu.

Construction and Completion of Roads in the Trobu Constituency

Ms Gloria Owusu (NPP — Trobu): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the following roads in the Trobu Constituency will be constructed and completed: (i) Asofa-Amamorley (ii) Pokuase-Katapor (iii) Omanjor-Dwenewoho (iv) Golden Door-Yellow House (v) Agric Quarters-Abensu (vi) Ayawaso-Achiato area (vii) Afiaman Community (viii) Tantra and Capital Hill Area.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, all the roads mentioned by Hon Colleague are in the Ga North Municipality:

- (i) Asofa-Amamorley;
- (ii) Omanjor-Dwenehon;
- (iii) Golden Door-Yellow House;
- (iv) Agric Quarters-Abensu;
- (v) Ayawaso -Achiato area;
- (vi) Afiaman Community; and
- (vii) Tantra and Capital Hill Area.

Background

The Ga North Municipality is one of the 29 assemblies in the Greater Accra Region. Its capital is Ofankor. The aforementioned roads are located within the Municipality.

Current Programme

There are no programmes on the above roads.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies will be carried out on the roads for consideration under the 2026 Budget, upon the availability of funds.

(ii) Pokuase-Katapor

Background

The Pokuase - Katapor feeder road is 8.2 km long. It is a connector road located in the Ga West Municipality of the Greater Accra Region. It is an engineered gravel road in poor condition.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

The Department of Feeder Roads has undertaken engineering studies on the road, and cost estimates have been submitted for consideration. The execution of the works would be considered under the 2026 Budget, depending on the availability of funds.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary?

Ms Owusu: Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Hon Minister when the engineering studies for these roads will begin.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, the various agencies under the Ministry automatically programme these roads for studies. Once it says that the engineering studies will be carried out, I am sure that we need to carry them out this year for them to be programmed for the 2026 Budget. So, somewhere within the year, the engineering studies will be carried out.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further question?

Ms Owusu: Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Minister if the Ministry has visited any of these roads in the last six months to assess their condition.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, it is not the Ministry that visits the roads. The agencies under the Ministry automatically carry this out. In fact, since it is a Municipality, there would have been a Department of Urban Roads or Feeder Roads that has visited them and they have data on all these roads. So, I can assure my Colleague that the agencies under the Ministry will carry out the engineering studies and make recommendations for consideration within the 2026 Budget.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Your last supplementary question if any.

Ms Owusu: Mr Speaker, can the Hon Minister assure the people of Trobu that these roads will be part of the priority road in the 2026 Budget?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, the Government prioritises all roads and, based on the availability of funds, we undertake works. We have not got the priority list for 2026. We are currently working on what has been approved in Parliament for this year. When we approve the 2026 Budget, based on what has been approved, we will apply that to the rest of the task ahead.

Ms Owusu: Mr Speaker, please—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are entitled to three supplementary questions and you have exhausted them. I owe fidelity to the Rules, so, kindly, resume your seat.

Let us move to the last Question for the Minister, which stands in the name of Mr Peter Lanchene Toobu.

State of Construction of Wa to Dorimon and Ga to Wechiau Roads

Supt Rtd Peter Lanchene Toobu (NDC — Wa West): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the state of the construction of the following roads: (i) Wa to Dorimon (ii) Ga to Wechiau.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

(i) Wa to Dorimon

Background

The Wa-Dorimon Road (0-11) is an Inter-Regional trunk road with a total length of 32 km within the Wa Municipality and Wa West District. The first 10 km on the road is a bituminous surface dressed and in good condition.

Current Programme

Sections of the Wa - Dorimon Road have been awarded in two lots as follows:

- a) Regravelling of Wa - Dorimon Road (Km 10-Km 15), lot 3; and
 - b) Regravelling of Wa - Dorimon Road (Km 15-Km 20), lot 4.
- a) **Regravelling of Wa - Dorimon Road (Km 10-Km 15), lot 3**

The contract commenced on 24th February, 2025, for completion by 23rd February, 2026. The contractor is on site and works are progressing steadily.

- b) **Regravelling of Wa - Dorimon Road (Km 15-Km 20) lot 4**

The contract commenced on 24th February, 2025, for completion by 23rd February, 2026. The contractor is on site and works are progressing steadily.

(ii) Upgrading of Wechiau - Ga Road (km 2.3-22.5)

Background

The Ga - Wechiau Road is part of the Dorimon - Ga Road (R182) and it is in

the Wa West District in the Upper West Region. It is a gravel surface road in poor condition.

Current Programme

The contract for the “**Upgrading of Wechiau – Ga (20.2km)**” commenced on 11th March, 2020, for completion by 11th September, 2022.

The physical progress of work to date is projected at 32 per cent completion. The contractor has demobilised from the site due to a delay in payment for work done. Warning letters have been issued for the contractor to return to the site, failure for which the contract will be terminated and repackaged for re-award.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further questions?

Supt Rtd Toobu: Rightly so, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, if I understand bituminous surface dressing, does it mean the Hon Minister said that there is bituminous on the road? Because I just returned from Wa West yesterday. If he can explain that; I am not technically sound. Is there coal tar on the road or is it dressed and ready for coal tar?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, the Answer I provided is that this road is 32 km. A section of that road is a bituminous surface and a majority of which is gravel in poor condition. That is the Answer I gave. So, I did not indicate that the entire road is in good condition. I said a section has been tarred in the past, but the rest is all in poor condition.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further questions?

Supt Rtd Toobu: Mr Speaker, can the Hon Minister provide the names of the two contractors? That is the one on the Dorimon - Wa Road and the one on the Gar - Wechiau Road.

4.17 p.m.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, for the Wa to Dorimon Road, the name of the contractor is Messrs Hal-Siita Enterprise Ltd and the contractor for the other one is Messrs Likos Enterprise. The contractor for the third one is Messrs Baa-Ntimah Ghana Limited.

Mr Speaker, those are the names of the contractors working on these roads.

Supt Rtd Toobu: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for my last supplementary question.

I would like to plead with the Hon Minister that the fact that contractors are on site on paper, does not reflect the reality on the ground. I can say with certainty that there is no contractor on site for the—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are breaching the rules. You are supposed to ask questions; be reminded of Order 88(7).

Supt Rtd Toobu: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

When will the Hon Minister pay Wa West a visit?

Mr Speaker, I am grateful.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, we have more than 100,000 kilometres of road. As much as possible, I visit places. I do not underestimate the need for what my Colleague has talked about, but if I understand him well, his concern is when the contractors will be on site and working. I agree with him that a contractor taking possession of site and having equipment on site does not necessarily equate to the contractor working.

Let me be frank, Mr Speaker. The reason majority of contractors are not actually working on site is because of the inability of Government to pay for works they have done previously. I previously said here that we owe road contractors up to September last year an amount of GH¢21 billion. If we were to add up till date, it would probably be more than GH¢23 billion. All we need to do is to make sure that we have enough resources to pay contractors and they will be on site.

I am happy that the Hon Member has been oversighting what the contractor is doing in his area. That is what is expected of us, as Members of Parliament. I hope that very soon, we will be able to make some payments for works done. When we do that, we will be able to ensure that contractors go back to site and carry out some of these works.

Mr Speaker, I would want to also appeal to Colleagues that we should all pay attention to what contractors come to do in our communities. There are too

many complaints about works not being done to the standard that is required. We can all monitor and make sure that works are done according to the standard we all require.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Minister.

Hon Members, this brings us to the end of Questions slated for the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways. On my own behalf and on behalf of the House, I thank the Minister for attending upon the House and providing answers to Questions. Hon Minister, you are hereby discharged.

Yes, First Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Roads and Highways—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member—

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I have not seen him dressed this way. Maybe, there is a secret. Is it because of the US\$360 million that was approved yesterday that he has dressed—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, by the Order Paper, we do not have Questions slated for him.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we want to urge the Frontbench on the other Side, so that with your leave, we take the

items listed 9 – Presentation of Papers. It is a tall list of Reports and Papers that we want to quickly lay, then we can go back to Statements. We have two important Statements.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, at the Commencement of Public Business—Yes?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, can he be specific because there are lots of Papers to be laid under the item numbered 9. So, which one in specific or is it all of it?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, he even added that there is a tall list of items to be presented. Any opposing view, Minority Leadership?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we do not have any problem with that, except the issue that I raised. That if he is laying everything, I do not know— Even though the Chairman of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs is here, I do not know whether the Report is ready to be laid. All right, then we have no difficulty.

[Pause]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Chief Whip, before giving you the floor, permit me to acknowledge the presence of our revered students.

Hon Members, we have students from the University of Ghana Accra City Campus Political Science Students

Association (POSSA). Their leaders are Samuel Danso and Gerhard Selasi Kanotey. They are Presidents and they are from the Korle Klottey Constituency. They are 58 in number.

[Students of the University of Ghana Accra City Campus POSSA were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We also have representatives from 20 Clusters of Schools in the Ahanta West Constituency, led by Benedict Obeng, a teacher. They are 30 in number.

May I welcome you, on behalf of the Parliament of the Republic of Ghana. May you enjoy a fruitful visit. Thank you very much.

[Pupils of 20 Clusters of Schools were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip, any indication?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so. Mr Speaker, may we take the Reports under the item numbered 9(a)?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I was going to apply, but my Leader is here, so he will take them himself.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Members, the item numbered 9(a)(i).

PAPERS

By the Majority Leader—

Report of the Auditor-General on the Management of Petroleum Funds for the Period January to December 2024.

Referred to the Public Accounts Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The item numbered 9(a)(ii).

By the Majority Leader—

Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana – Public Universities and Colleges of Education for the Year Ended 31st December, 2024.

Referred to the Public Accounts Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The item numbered 9(a)(iii).

By the Majority Leader—

Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana - Ministries, Departments and Other Agencies for the Year Ended 31st December, 2024.

Referred to the Public Accounts Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The item numbered 9(a)(iv).

4.27 p.m.

By the Majority Leader—

Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the Utilisation of GNPC's Share of the Petroleum Revenue on Infrastructure Projects.

Referred to the Public Accounts Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The item numbered 9(a)(v).

By the Majority Leader—

Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on Computerised Financial and Electronic Systems in Selected Covered Entities as at 31st December, 2024.

Referred to the Public Accounts Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader do we take the item numbered 9(b)(i) and 9(b) (ii)?

By the Chairman of the Committee—

- (i) Report of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs on the determination of the urgency of the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bills, 2025.

- (ii) Report of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs on the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bills, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader, may we take item numbered 9(c)?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the item numbered 9(c) is not ready.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Then item numbered 10.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Sports and Recreation is here. If you would indulge us so that he will lay the Regulation on behalf of the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology.

We have resolved the issues.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, that is fine.

Well, just a small question because the Minister responsible for Environment, Science and Technology had indicated to the House that there were issues with it so it was deferred. But the Majority Leader just gave indication that those issues have been resolved. So, I do not think we have any difficulty in it being laid so it can be laid.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minister responsible for Sports and Recreation, the item numbered 10.

INSTRUMENT

Environmental Protection (Petroleum) Regulations, 2025

Laid by the Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adam) on behalf of the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology. Referred to the Committee on Subsidiary Legislation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any indication?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, just to draw your attention to Order 229(4) as consequential to your referrals to the Public Accounts Committee. It provides:

“Where a matter for consideration before the Committee relates to the period of administration of the Party of the Chairperson of the Committee, the Ranking Member of the Committee shall be the chairperson for the consideration of that matter.”

All these Reports relate to the year 2024 and the present Chairperson was in government in 2024. Just so that you can give the consequential directives that the Chairperson should be the Ranking on that Committee for the consideration of all these Auditor-General Reports that you have referred to the Committee; 2024 Reports.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader, I thought this is a matter of course that the Committee would have to take into consideration. At the Committee level, they have to take this matter into consideration and that

will inform the Committee as to who should chair when they are considering these matters. So, I direct the Committee to take the Standing Orders into consideration in deciding whoever should be a Chairperson for the Public Accounts Committee.

Yes?

Mr Annoh-Dompseh: Mr Speaker, I think with respect to the Leader, it is a bit superfluous. I have engaged the Leadership of the Appointments Committee; the provision of the Standing Order that the Leader quoted, is not lost on them. These matters, are not lost on them. These matters are known, Mr Speaker, and they are going to respect the provision of the Standing Order. So, I do not think there is an issue at all. Of course, I support the Leader. I support but there are other businesses that are waiting for a call from the Leader. Probably, we should re-channel our energies to the outstanding matters. As for this one, it is a matter of course. It is going to be done.

Mr First Deputy Leader: Hon Minority Leader, there is nothing absolutely wrong if the Majority Leader is drawing our attention to this.

Mr Annoh Dompseh: Mr Speaker, I am your friend.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I know. You are my very good friend.

Mr Annoh Dompseh: I am only saying that there are good businesses outstanding; the one the Chairman just laid. There are other Papers to be laid. Let us do them. This one—No problem. Leader, you are not wrong.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Leader, with the indication from the Minority Chief Whip, do we take the Motions numbered 12 and 13? The Reports of the Committee on the Fisheries Bill, — Determination of the urgency or otherwise.

Mr Ayariga: I think we can take item numbered 12.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Chairman of the Committee, item numbered 12— Motion.

MOTIONS

Suspension of Order 104(1)

Chairman of the Committee (Dr Godfred Siedu Jasaw):

Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is given, the Motion for the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs on the determination of the urgency of the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bills, 2025 may be moved today.

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, item numbered 13?

Chairman of the Committee?

Report on the Determination of the Urgency of the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bills, 2025

Chairman of the Committee (Dr Godfred Siedu Jasaw): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs on the determination of the urgency of the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bills, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Chairman of the Committee, in doing so, present the Committee's Report.

Mr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the guidance. In doing so, I wish to present your Committee's Report on the urgency and please allow me to invite *Hansard* to capture the full content of the Report as if it was read in its entirety.

Mr Speaker, while doing that, let me just highlight that Ghana's fisheries subsector is facing some challenges, one of which is the issuance of a yellow card warning by the European Union. Mr Speaker, this was issued in 2021, and at this stage, if this country does not do anything about it, especially restructuring the legal regime and governance of the subsector, there is a tendency that a red card could be issued.

4.37 p.m.

Mr Speaker, this would deprive us of revenue amounting to over US\$400 million annually. Mr Speaker, at the same time, the fisheries stock in our waters is at critical levels, and there is a need for us to strengthen the legal regimes so that we can harvest them sustainably.

Mr Speaker, that said, together with other reasons captured in your Report on paragraph 3.1 and 3.13, I beg to invite this House to accept the recommendations of the Committee that the Bill be taken under a certificate of urgency. The Report submitted herewith, Mr Speaker. Thank you.

Question proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Ranking Member?

Ranking Member of the Committee (Dr Isaac Yaw Opoku): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, I beg to support the Motion and in supporting the Motion, I want to make a few comments.

Mr Speaker, the importance of the fisheries sector is not in doubt. According to the Fisheries Commission, the sector, between 2014 and 2023, contributed between about 5.4 per cent to the agricultural Gross Domestic Product (GDP). It also contributes to the raw materials for the canaries and the fish-related industries.

Mr Speaker, apart from the fish that we get from the marine, it may interest you to also learn that 70 to 80 per cent of

the oxygen we breathe comes from the marine plants. So, it is important that we do not destroy the ecosystem. Some fishermen have been using illegal chemicals to destroy not only the fish but also the plants in the marine. We need a robust legal framework to govern all the fishing activities.

Mr Speaker, looking at the Report as presented by your Committee, under paragraph 3.3, the legal framework governing the fisheries sector are the “Fisheries Act, 2002 (Act 625), as amended by the Fisheries (Amendment) Act, 2014 (Act 880), and is supported by the Fisheries Regulation, 2010 (L.I. 1968)”. These laws have not seen any major changes since their enactment. There are a lot of inconsistencies in the laws, so we need a robust legal framework to govern all the fishing activities.

The current law as it stands, does not address the international as well as the local standards. At the international level, only a few regulations are addressed, and if we come to the local level too, a lot of the key issues have also not been addressed. On issues like aquaculture, the current law concentrates mainly on the marine, it does not address aquaculture practises. It does not also address climate change and coal management.

Mr Speaker, it is important that we get a robust legal framework to address the fisheries sector. So, I urge Hon Colleagues on both Sides to support the Motion and adopt the Committee’s Report in recommending the Motion for adoption. Mr Speaker, I so submit.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon First Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu (NPP—Tolon): Thank you, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, my concern is about the urgency of the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025. To what end is it urgent? Why do we think we need to go on that path? I remember very well in the Eighth Parliament, the Chairman now was the Deputy Ranking Member and I was a Member of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs. We considered this Bill extensively. The urgency is to the effect that they have enhanced their consultation; they brought in a ratification document here to put a burden on fisherfolks. The Majority Chief Whip is the Chairman of premix fuel. They have taken the subsidy out, and now they are coming with an urgent document again to do what? To put more burden on fisherfolks?

Mr Speaker, as much as this Bill is important, it is not urgent. So, coming to say or arguing that it should come under certificate of urgency and then trying to rush us into First and Second Reading of this Bill is definitely going to be a problem. Mr Speaker, I do admit that yes, Ghana has been issued a yellow card by the European Commission from 2021, but that is not a justification for the urgency of the Bill. It is not because we have been on that yellow card; the same yellow card that we were on when Hon Jasaw and Hon Eric Opoku would tell us that the yellow card does not mean we should put burden on fishermen or fisherfolks; that was their argument then. And today they have come with a

ratification on the same yellow card and we have supported them.

The current Minister was in the fishing communities campaigning during the 2024 election, on the need for fishermen and fisherfolks to be empowered. Now they have taken many of the subsidies out; there is no alternative livelihood for the fisherfolks, they are putting more burden, and at the same time, they are saying that it is still urgent. So, is it urgent to put a burden on fisherfolks? Is it urgent to take subsidies from fisherfolks? —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, there were Questions from your Side directed at the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture to the effect that Ghana stands to be given a red card. And the answer from the Minister was to the effect that if this Bill were passed, complying with the international conventions and treaties, we will not be given the red card. Do you not think as a result, there is a need to urgently pass this particular Bill to avoid Ghana being given a red card?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, for the love that I have for this our country, Ghana, I will calm down on it. But Mr Speaker, it was the same argument when they brought in the ratification. The ratification of that treaty was to the effect that if we do not — the Minister was here when the Chairman said that if we do not ratify the treaty, we would be shown a red card, and now, that has come to pass. Now they are bringing another Bill and saying that it is urgent.

So, Mr Speaker, for the love for our country — and the Chairman used to be my Hon Friend. He is my former Friend. So, I will just conclude by saying that for the love we have for the country, we do not want Ghana to be shown a red card. But the next time the Minister is bringing things, it should not also be under a certificate of urgency to the effect that because we have been given a yellow card, we are putting a burden on the fisherfolks. With that, Mr Speaker I will not say I support the urgency of the Bill, but I will just say that I will lower down my guns from the directive that you have given for us to move on.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Member.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor (NDC — South Dayi): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to add my voice that this Bill be taken under the certificate of urgency. Mr Speaker, the Committee's own findings contained in particularly paragraph 3.3 indicates that as many as five statutes and instruments govern the current framework. But they are very archaic, so to speak.

4.47 p.m.

The Committee further established in paragraph 3(9) of the Report that because of some of the issues, we were issued with a yellow card by the European Union (EU) and again, it could result in the issuance of a red card.

Mr Speaker, the urgency backing the passage of the Bill is also reflected in the fact that, just a couple of weeks ago, this House ratified the World Trade Organisation (WTO) Agreement on the Fisheries Subsidies and the misapprehension of my Brothers on the other Side—The passage of the Bill is not in respect of the fact that subsidies will be taken away. The taking away of the subsidies is in respect of improper and illegal fishing practices. That is what the ratification of the WTO Instrument or the Convention will do. So, the Ministry has seen it fit to come to this House with this new proposed legislation, to as it were, consolidate all the existing different legal frameworks on the fisheries subsector into one legislation, so that will be in conformity with the WTO Instrument.

Mr Speaker, so, it is urgent that we do that, so that we can benefit greatly under this international convention.

Mr Speaker, with these words I urge the House to adopt the Report, so we can proceed to take the substantive Report from the Committee and move into the Consideration Stage of the Bill.

Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity.

Question put and Motion agreed to

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Order Paper *Addendum* 2, the Motion numbered 2. Yes, Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development.

BILLS — SECOND READING

Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025

Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development (Ms Emelia Arthur) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.

Chairman of the Committee (Dr Godfred Seidu Jasaw): Mr Speaker —

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu — rose —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think the procedural Motion numbered one, the Minister—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Having determined the urgency, the House will no longer move a procedural Motion, so it was a mistake on the Order Paper.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: All right. Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: This is because, the Motion to determine the urgency of the Bill has already been determined.

Yes, Minister, you are right.

Any seconder?

Dr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, I rise to support the Motion, and in doing so, I present your Committee's Report. Mr Speaker, please allow *Hansard* to

capture the full content of the Report as if it was read in its entirety.

1.0 Introduction

1.1 The Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, was presented to the House by the Hon Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture (MoFA), Madam Emelia Arthur, on Tuesday, 3rd June, 2025. In accordance with Standing Order 160(1), the Minister, upon presentation and first reading, requested that the Bill be considered under certificate of urgency.

1.2 The Bill was subsequently referred to the Committee on Food, Agriculture, and Cocoa Affairs for consideration and report in accordance with Article 106(4), (5) and (13) and Order 160(2) of the Standing Orders.

1.3 Accordingly, the Committee met on Wednesday, 4th and Thursday, 5th June, 2025, and considered the referral.

2.0 Deliberations

2.1 The Committee, in its deliberations on the Bill, met with the Hon Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture, Madam Emelia Arthur, senior officers of the Ministry, the Fisheries Commission, the National Premix Fuel Committee, and officials of the Attorney-General's Office & Ministry of Justice

2.2 The Committee however took note of the fact that the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs of the Eighth Parliament had actually carried out extensive consultation with the Ministry and stakeholders in the fisheries industry on the Bill. The current text of the Bill has thus been enriched by the outcome of the broad consultations and extensive discussions with critical stakeholders ranging from the Fisheries Commission, National Premix Fuel Committee, the Ghana Tuna Association, the Canoe and Fishing Gear Owners Association of Ghana (CaFGOAG), and Environmental Justice Foundation (EJF).

3.0 **Background and Urgency for Passage of the Bill**

3.1 The fisheries and aquaculture sectors contribute significantly to national development particularly in the areas of job and wealth creation, poverty reduction, Gross Domestic Product contribution and foreign exchange and will remain so provided the resources are managed sustainably.

3.2 The sustainable management, utilisation and exploitation of the fisheries and aquaculture resources require the existence of robust legal framework that govern fishing activities, regulates resource extraction, and ensures compliance with international and national environmental standards.

3.3 The current legal framework governing the fisheries sector comprises the Fisheries Act, 2002 (Act 625), as amended by the Fisheries (Amendment) Act, 2014 (Act 880), and is supported by the Fisheries Regulations, 2010 (L.I.1968) and the Fisheries (Amendment) Regulations, 2015 (L.I. 2217). There is also the National Premix Fuel Committee Regulations, 2016 (L.I. 2233). These laws aim to provide a comprehensive legal and institutional framework for the sustainable management of fisheries resources and the promotion of aquaculture development in Ghana.

3.4 However, the Fisheries Act, 2002 (Act 625), since its enactment in 2002 and Act 880 empower the Minister to develop regulations aimed at combating Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated fishing, has not seen major changes to reflect emerging trends in sustainable fisheries management.

3.5 Decisions and recommendations from various international fisheries Organisations, conventions and treaties, such as the Port State Measures Agreement to Prevent, Deter and Eliminate Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated fishing, which Ghana is a signatory to, have also not been adequately expressed in Act 625.

3.6 Additionally, Act 625 falls short in addressing key local fisheries

issues, such as aquacultural practices, post-harvest management, and trade. Act 625 also lacks comprehensive provisions for inland fisheries management, the selectivity of fishing gear, the impact of climate change on fisheries and co-management practices.

3.7 A review of the fisheries and related legislation of the country conducted by the World Bank-funded West African Regional Fisheries Programme in 2015 and the Food and Agriculture Organisation in 2019, for instance, revealed gaps in Act 625. Both Reports noted that some international requirements were only partially addressed in the current legislation. The Reports also identified inconsistencies within the fisheries legal framework, primarily resulting from successive amendments that have not been systematically consolidated into a single Act. These inconsistencies were identified between Act 625 and the amendment to Act 625, as well as between the Acts and their corresponding Regulations.

3.8 Given the foregoing challenges, the Bill seeks to modernise the existing legal framework to better support the sustainable fisheries resource management, enhance food security and the sector's contribution to national development. These legislative reforms are also designed to align Ghana with international

fisheries management obligations, ensuring both ecological and economic sustainability in the long term.

3.9 Ghana was issued a yellow card by the European Commission (EC) in 2021 for failing to adequately tackle Illegal, Unreported, and Unregulated (IUU) fishing. Failure to act swiftly in changing the legal regime could result in the issuance of a red card by the EU. A red card would result in a complete ban on the exportation of fish and fishery products to the European market, leading to an estimated loss of USD425,969,296.32.

3.10 These weaknesses, identified in reviews conducted by the World Bank-funded West African Regional Fisheries Programme (WARFP) and the Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO), have revealed Ghana's fragmented fisheries legal structure. The country's fisheries legal framework fails to address critical issues such as biosecurity, climate change, inland fisheries management, and post-harvest trade. These deficiencies expose the country to serious risks, both economically and environmentally.

3.11 Given that, the Parliament of Ghana recently passed a resolution and ratified the World Trade Organisation (WTO) treaty on fisheries subsidies. Immediate steps are required to be taken to domesticate the provisions of the treaty in local laws and regulations by member States.

3.12 The Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, has therefore been developed by the Ministry of Fisheries and Aquaculture, in collaboration with the Ministry of Justice and the Attorney-General's Department, key national stakeholders, and with support from Development Partners. It seeks, among other things, to establish a modern legal frame-work to enhance the governance, development, and sustainability of Ghana's fisheries and aquaculture sector, which is pivotal to the national economy.

3.13. The Bill also now emphasises provisions on aquaculture production and its governance along a value chain. It provides for stronger sanctions regime for infractions and other illegal, unregulated and unreported activities at sea. It adopts an ecosystem-based approach to sustainable management of the fisheries stocks, including mapping out marine protected areas and extension of economic zones. It further includes provisions on safety, security and working conditions aboard fishing vessels.

3.14 Taking cognisance of the issues addressed in paragraphs 4.1 to 4.13, it is the considered opinion of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs that the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 be taken under a certificate of urgency pursuant to Article 106(13) of the Constitution and Order 160(3) & (4) of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

4.0 Conclusion

After a careful consideration of the Bill in accordance with Article 106(5) & (13), and pursuant to Order 160(3), the Committee hereby informs the House that the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, is of an urgent nature and should be considered pursuant to Article 106(13) and Standing Order 160(4) of Parliament.

Mr Speaker, the importance of this Bill cannot be overemphasised. Accordingly, you referred this Bill to your Committee. We had extensive deliberations; stakeholder meetings and engagements and the content of the Bill that was presented in the last Parliament has now been enriched to the extent that we are satisfied that the Ministry's objective of governing the fisheries subsector in a sustainable manner is captured in legislation as rendered in this Bill.

We are also convinced that there are more punitive and stringent measures for flouting or engaging in illegal, unreported and unregulated fishing in the subsector. We are also convinced that the rest of the subsectors within the fisheries space is now strengthened in the legal arrangements that we have here.

Mr Speaker, we are convinced that with the passage of this Bill, the yellow card warning will be withdrawn by the European Union and allow for more exports of the water species to our external countries for more foreign exchange to be brought into this country.

Mr Speaker, we have proposed amendments that have been captured in your Committee's Report on page nine. And I will conclude by saying that after a careful consideration of the Bill in accordance with Article 106(5) and (13), and pursuant to Order 160(3), the Committee hereby informs the House that the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, is of an urgent nature and the Committee accordingly recommends that the House adopts its Report on this Bill for implementation.

Respectfully submitted.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Member.

Question proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member.

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP — Takoradi): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to add my voice to this second reading of the Bill. Mr Speaker, we all know that fisheries is a very major component of the national Gross Domestic Product (GDP). We are also aware that these issues have been there for a very long time. In fact, the first time I joined Parliament, over 16 years ago, the issues that are actually in this current amendment were issues that were being looked at, especially the issue of co-management. This is because a lot of the time, because the management of the national resources are at the centre, it is

difficult to manage them locally as well. And it is therefore very important that with the issuance of the yellow card, we needed to re-look at our own legal framework to ensure that Ghana can play a significant role in the national and global fisheries industry.

Mr Speaker, one area that keeps coming up over the years has been the issue of unreported and illegal fishing. Mr Speaker, we can see that the business of overfishing is something that we have discussed in this country for a very long time, to the extent that, under the previous administration, the issue of closed season became a major national input. Unfortunately, our Brothers on this Side continued to tell the fishermen that they were going to stop it immediately they come to power, but everybody knows what has happened. They have extended it. This year, they are going to close it again. So, I believe that they should apologise to the people of Ghana, especially our fishermen, for lying to them that they were going to stop the closed season being practiced in this country.

Mr Speaker, we want to support them to do the right thing, but there should be fairness in political competition in this country—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I will recognise the point of order in view of the word that you used.

Mr Dafeamekpor: *On a point of order.* Mr Speaker, my Brother is a senior Member and he knows that he could say all the things he said without

having to use that phrase. Mr Speaker, I urge him to withdraw and let us make progress.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think this is one of the reasons the Speaker said that Members of Parliament should not be serving on boards. It is quite interesting. He is the Chairman of the Board for National Premix Fuel Committee. That is the reason he has raised this issue. *[Laughter]*—He is in direct conflict of interest and that is the reason he raised it —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib, does the fact that he is a Board Member for National Premix Fuel Committee justify a Member using unparliamentary language?

Hon Kwabena, just do the needful.

Mr Darko-Mensah: Mr Speaker, I withdraw the word and use the word “untruth”. Is that alright with you?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr Darko-Mensah: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the fact of the matter is that our fisherfolks seem to be in the bracket of where poverty is found in Ghana. And I believe, that if we look at what is coming up now about the aquaculture, the idea is to make sure that it is expanded and deepened. I believe that we have to forcefully find a new way of introducing aquaculture even in coastal communities, so that they can use

that to back up the limited resources they get from the sea, which is more like “try your luck” or hunting of fish. But if they can cultivate them consistently over a period of six months, they can use that to support their income from the coastal fishing activities that they do.

4.57 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I believe that this country needs to support the Hon Minister to make sure that this Bill is passed. It will naturally support our economy, job creation in the fishing communities, and, if we get it done well, boost the incomes of our people and create wealth for them and then the poverty levels in these communities will also go down.

So, with these few words, Mr Speaker, I believe that we need to support this Bill. But next time, the NDC should not—*[...Expunged by order of Mr Speaker]*—about the things that they have come to face in government.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Dr Murtala Mohammed?

Dr Murtala Muhammed Ibrahim: Mr Speaker, he made a statement and you asked him to withdraw. He withdrew and concluded by saying that we should not peddle untruth, which will be captured by the *Hansard*. So, I think that it should be expunged—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I direct that any statement relating to —be expunged from the *Hansard*.

Yes, Mr Nitiwul?

Mr Dominic Bingab Aduna Nitiwul (NPP — Bimbilla): Mr Speaker, I think that my Friends who are opposition should not be too hard on themselves. Over the years, we have politicised the issue of fishing and that should never have been the case. But, unfortunately, that is what has happened. When they were in opposition, they wanted to do everything they could to get the votes of the people, so they politicised it.

I just hope that, as politicians, we learn a lesson not to do it. Because of that, we have allowed our fish stocks, especially within the oceans, to dwindle to the extent that the lives of more than two to five million people are at risk because they are no more getting the sort of fish they are supposed to get. So, I would say that we should support Government to reform and amend this Bill and ensure that the gaps that have been identified in the Fisheries Act, 2002 (Act 625) are properly catered for and addressed.

Mr Speaker, it is difficult for a legal regime or framework not to address issues such as biosecurity or climate change. Climate change has become a very huge factor in the world and, for our Act not to address serious issues like climate change, we are risking the lives of even the people who are doing this fishing, both on-shore and on-land. For inland fishing management, fresh water fish in Ghana is becoming a problem for many people because it is simply drying off. We are just lucky that we have the Volta Lake. Even with Volta Lake, we are still having problems.

The quantity of fish that a fisherman will get, especially within the lean period when it is not raining, is very tiny. Unless you have not been visiting fishermen, but if you visit fishermen, you will realise that they are struggling just to survive. But that is their livelihood—*[Interruption]*—Mr Speaker, we have water in Bimbilla to drink; we do not have a river—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you know the Rules that you have to address me. You do not listen to others.

Mr Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, I just said that it is important that these new amendments, which our Committee has really looked at, addresses some of these critical issues. And the post-harvest trade and post-harvest losses, once some of these things are addressed, I believe that the Bill will be modernised enough to be able to support sustainable fishing across the country for us. So, I want to support the Minister and it is good that she is doing this. Let us help the Hon Minister to craft a Bill that will last a long time, support our people, and grow this sector. It was just in 2002 that we did the Bill; today, we are seeing big gaps. To the extent that we have been giving yellow card to a big market like the European Union; it is not good for us.

Mr Speaker, I think that we should do something about it. So, this is not the time for politics, but I think that we should begin to really look at what we do with the lives of the millions of people, especially those in the coast and those along the major river bodies: from Aflao

on the east to Elubu in the west and then from Sogakope right down to those at Paga area or those at Bole area and all those along those areas. We have to look at what they do and how we can support them.

So, Mr Speaker, I think that, once we support the Hon Minister, it is important to focus also on inland farming and aquaculture. Because the biggest mistake we are making is aquaculture. If people had the sort of lands that we had, we should be enjoying a lot of good fish meals, which are healthier than some of the fatty foods that we are eating, which is not good for our health. If you just look at us, as Members, most of us are sick with our stomachs protruding like this. We are all sick people, but I believe that if we are able to reform this—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But who told you if somebody is having a protruding stomach, the person is sick?

Mr Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, I do not want any politician to do propaganda against me and say that fat people are sick. But the truth is that you have to re-look at yourself. If you decide to have a protruding stomach as if you are nine months pregnant, you have to re-look at yourself. Because you are having visceral fat. It is fat, nothing else. It is stored energy and nothing more; you are sick. And if you look at things like fatty liver, you are a sick person.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Dr Nitiwul's theory—

Mr Nitiwul: It is a correct theory, Mr Speaker.

But, Mr Speaker, I want to conclude by encouraging the Hon Minister to use this Bill to address issues of aquaculture. It is very important. She should use this Bill to address issues and to see how she can stimulate aquaculture within Ghana, especially in the north. Because in the dry season, sometimes, it is very difficult to get protein. Animal protein, yes, but when it comes to fish, it is sometimes very difficult. But we have flat land enough. We have water underground. So, if we are able to do the legal framework that will help our people, Mr Speaker, I believe that we will be running to the hospital less. And if we are running to the hospital less, the country will spend less. So, I support the Bill and I encourage my Colleagues to support the Bill and hope that the Minister and all of us, as Parliament, will pass a Bill that will last us a long time.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon First Deputy Minority Whip?

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu): Mr Speaker, I also rise to support the Bill on the grounds that nobody would be happy if Ghana is shown a red card. But the Hon Minister, now, I think, would be humble enough to know that the reality is different from what we do when we are campaigning to the effect that we will empower fisherfolks.

At the moment, we all know that the subsidy on pre-mix fuel has been taken off. The subsidy on outboard motors has

been taken off. They promised that there is not going to be a closed season, but, seemingly, it looks like we are getting to a closed season or something like that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Alhaji Habib Iddrisu, on grounds of relevance, how does subsidy emanate from the Report?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, they brought a treaty for ratification to the effect that that is taken off and that emanates from this Bill. That is why it is of relevance. Because it is this House—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Which clause?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I was here. I contributed to the debates when the ratification was before us on the World Trade Organisation (WTO) and the subsidies were taken out. In fact, the essence of the ratification, per what I told the Minister and the Minister presented to the House, was never—But is it true that the Ministry has taken subsidy from outboard motors or not? Is it true that the Ministry has taken subsidy from premix fuel or not?

Mr Speaker, as much as I support this Bill to the effect that Ghana should not be shown a red card, the Minister should be aware that she needs more money and there should be an alternative livelihood for the fisherfolk. Because it is a serious problem when fishermen barely break even. So, there must be an alternative livelihood for the fisherfolk. The closed season that the Ministry promised has already started. So, next time when the

Minister is campaigning, she should know that it is not everything that we do politics with.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, what is your position?

5.07 p.m.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I support it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I agree, but for the record, your position is that people who are involved in illegal and unregulated fishing should be granted subsidy.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I never said so. Those are your words.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But the ratification that we did was on illegal and unregulated fishing. I presided over it, so I know that it is illegal and unregulated fishing, not removal of subsidy in total. The international community does not want someone who is involved in illegal fishing or unregulated fishing to be granted subsidy. So, you are supporting illegality by granting illegal and unregulated people who are involved in illegal and unregulated fishing a subsidy.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Minister in that ratification spoke about fishing efforts. They also talked about unreported, so I do not know, if something is unreported, we cannot—
[Interruption]—

Mr Speaker, without saying much, I support the Bill and the Minister should

take a cue from the concerns that have been raised by Members. I do not know how the Minister is going to help the fisherfolk because the Ministry of Finance is not releasing any funding to her. That is why the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology is here because he has no releases. He is only here because he does not have any releases. That is why he is always here. The Minister for Finance should give the Ministers money, so that they can go and work and they will not be in the Chamber to heckle their Colleagues.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Majority Leadership? Yes, the Minister?

Mrs Arthur: Mr Speaker, I want to take this opportunity to thank the House for considering this Motion. Because this is a house of records, I would like to balance some uninformed commentary that has come up on the Floor.

Mr Speaker, there is a certain terminology—

Mr Baffour Awuah — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister, hold on.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Nana Adjei Baffour Awuah: Mr Speaker, very respectfully, I think that to use the term “uninformed language” is an unparliamentary phrase. I do not think it is appropriate to say that a Member of Parliament is expressing an

uninformed—Mr Speaker, the synonym is “uneducated”. Uninformed is the same as uneducated. Mr Speaker, I do not think it is appropriate.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, the House is offended by the use of the language uninformed.

Mrs Arthur: Mr Speaker, I—
[Uproar]—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Order!
Order!

Mrs Arthur: Mr Speaker, I wish to withdraw the phrase and I would like to say that there is a terminology in the fisheries sector known as Illegal, Unregulated and Unreported (IUU) fisheries and it cuts across a spectrum of certain activities that have consequences.

One of the consequences on Ghana is the issuance of the yellow card on the fisheries products of Ghana to the European Union (EU). It has been on for five years now; we have a very small window. If not lifted, we would get into red zone and what it means is that no fish exports will go into the EU market and we will lose over US\$400 million annually.

Mr Speaker, I would like to state further that this Bill that we are considering has at the heart, the national interest. It is first and foremost about the national interest of Ghana to create jobs through the fisheries sector, to grow the economy through the fisheries sector and to just do what is right in the fisheries

sector. The fisheries sector being one of our natural resource sectors.

I would like to also place on record that as we said we would do; we have done exactly that. When it comes to closed season as one of the many management measures in the fisheries sector, we said we will implement a closed season for the industrial fleet for two months. We have done so. *[Hear! Hear!]* We said we will implement a closed season for the sub-industrial season for one month; we are doing it. *[Hear! Hear!]* We also said that we will not implement a closed season for artisanal fishers and we are implementing it. *[Hear! Hear!]*

So, as I speak to Hon Members right now, there is no closed season for our artisanal fishers because a closed season—As I answered yesterday, when one of our Colleagues asked me the Question, closed season is just one of the many management measures in the fisheries sector and a management measure should have a number of objectives: conservation, social, or economic. We know and we have done the work and the science proves that the effect of the one-month sea closure on artisanal fishers does not answer all these three objectives. So, though we are not implementing a closed season for artisanal fishers, we are putting in place other measures. This is important for us to understand.

Mr Speaker, once again, because this is a house of records, I would like to balance a certain narrative that has come on this Floor. The World Trade

Organisation (WTO) Subsidies Treaty is rather a protection of fisherfolks in small countries like ours. It is to cure a situation where big rich countries give big subsidies to their vessels and that allows them to come into our waters and misbehave. We may be interested to note that since we signed on or ratified the ratification, some funding windows have opened for Ghana and we are putting in an application to benefit. *[Hear! Hear!]*

So, ratifying the WTO Treaty has not removed subsidies on premix. Subsidies on premix still exist up to today. It has not removed subsidies on outboard motors. In fact, premix supply has improved. It has not removed subsidies on outboard motors.

Mr Speaker, a comment was made that this new law should focus on climate change, biosecurity, inland fishery and aquaculture. I would like to assure the House that that is exactly what this Bill seeks to do. *[Hear! Hear!]* Within the broad context of the blue economy, we are not looking at fisheries as just capturing fish or growing fish. We are looking at fisheries in the context of competing interests of environment, of energy, of tourism and of water transport. We are looking at it broader and bigger because of the massive potential this sector has for the country.

5.17 p.m.

With these words, Mr Speaker, I would like to thank the House once again for considering this Bill. Thank you very much. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I just want to thank the Minister for informing the House; for making it possible for this House to take a decision from a more informed position. *[Laughter]*

Mr Speaker, it would have been a disaster for us to take this decision in an uninformed position. But obviously, we are now more informed. We thank the Minister very much.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, accordingly read a Second time.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, may I suggest that in order to curtail issues at the Consideration Stage of this Bill, we refer it to the Winnowing Committee, so that whatever the concern of the Winnowing Committee is, we add it to the Committee's proposed consideration. And then we can deal with it at that stage once and for all.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip, what do you say to this?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we are in agreement. I believe that the Majority Leader's Committee will be able to tidy up. It is quite a bulky Bill. So we will do the tidying up. Once we come back to the Floor, the consideration will be smooth sailing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, he was engaging the Majority Leader. Mr Speaker's call for the Bill to be referred at this stage to the Winnowing Committee for them to tidy it up needs your buy-in. Is that what he said? So, Mr Speaker, we can proceed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Are you in agreement?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Yes, of course.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. If that is the sense of the House, I will then refer the Bill to the Winnowing Committee to tidy it up, so that the workload at the Consideration Stage will be reduced drastically.

Hon Members, thank you very much. Yes, any indication?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so. May we come back to the item numbered 8, which is Statements. Mr Speaker, I am pleading that there is a very important Statement. This Statement is quite important to the Hon Member from Ahanta, because it is about the Ahanta language, and she brought in students from Ahanta.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I have two Statements before me. One is in the name of Hon Patricia Appiagyei on the "Monitoring and Evaluation in Good Governance". The other one is a Statement by Hon Mavis Kuukua Bissie, Member of Parliament for Ahanta West Constituency.

Hon Members, if it pleases you, we may take these two Statements.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, first of all, you have always encouraged us to respect the Standing Orders. We clearly stand in breach of Order 93(8). And you know how tomorrow has been devoted to the Indian Prime Minister. And Mr Speaker, Majority Leader, the Clerk and I have been engaging to rally Members into the Chamber. It is important. We have done a lot.

The two Statements are not commemorative, Mr Speaker. If they were commemorative Statements, then I would have yielded.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Chief Whip, I will plead with you that once the Statements are loaded, we take the two and limit the contribution to one on each Side, then Leadership will come in.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: My pleasure is that we defer to tomorrow or some other day. But Mr Speaker, if my Colleagues are insistent, that is all right.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. We will take one contribution each, then we can call it a day.

Hon Members, we have a Statement by the Hon Member for Ahanta West Constituency, on Reviving the Ahanta Language for Educational Equity and Cultural Identity.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

STATEMENTS

Reviving the Ahanta Language for Educational Equity and Cultural Identity

Ms Mavis Kuukua Bissie (NDC — Ahanta West): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to address this august House on the urgent need to preserve, revive and integrate the Ahanta language known as Ayinda into the formal education system. This is a matter of not only cultural heritage, but also educational equity, linguistic justice and constitutional fidelity.

Mr Speaker, like Ayinda, over 40 of Ghana's indigenous languages are now at risk of extinction according to the language scholars. I am an example of the dangers that lie ahead if we fail as a country to document and teach our indigenous languages. Despite being born to an Ahanta father and mother; I did not have the benefit of being taught the language at home or in school. We had no books from which I could read my language, and travelling and living out of Ghana, more than 25 years of my life, I had no reference point to connect with my mother tongue.

Today, like thousands of Ahanta people, I am unable to speak the language. My children too have no means of learning it. As a Member of Parliament for Ahanta West, I am determined, as one of my legacies, to change this.

Mr Speaker, Ayinda is a Central Tano language within the Kwa branch of

the Niger-Congo language family, spoken by the Ahanta people in the Western Region. It is similar to languages like Nzema, Brosa, Evalue and other languages that are spoken in the south-east Ivory Coast. For generations, this language has served as a medium of identity, oral history, governance and spirituality for the Ahanta people. Sadly, due to a long-standing marginalisation and the absence of state-led preservation efforts, the Ayinda language is now endangered, with fewer children speaking or understanding the ancestral tongue.

Mr Speaker, our Constitution under Article 39(3) mandates the State to ensure that the integration and development of Ghanaian languages are incorporated into national life. The Education Strategy Plan and numerous international conventions to which Ghana is a signatory, such as the African Union Language Plan of Action for Africa and UNESCO's Convention on Cultural Diversity, all recognise the importance of preserving indigenous languages as vehicles for identity, development and inclusion.

Upon assuming office, I convened a Language Renaissance Committee, which brought together the chiefs of Ahanta; the Ahanta Bible Translation Project, which has already developed the orthography for the language, the Ghana Education Service, experienced language teachers, media and other stakeholders. This collaborative body has spearheaded the Ahanta Language Renaissance Project, a grassroot-driven initiative

aimed at documenting, developing and teaching Ayinda in our schools.

5.27 p.m.

Mr Speaker, with the support of the Ahanta West Municipal Education Service, we have successfully selected 20 public basic schools across the Ahanta West Municipality for a pilot programme. In preparation, over 20 volunteers, teachers, have undergone specialised training in both the orthography and teaching methodology of the language sponsored by my office. These teachers are now ready to start the Ayinda teaching in their respective schools as we work to gather data for broader curriculum integration.

Mr Speaker, I am proud to announce that on Friday, 4th July, 2025, there will be a grand durbar to officially launch the Ahanta Language Renaissance Project. This will be a historic and unifying occasion for the Ahanta people, educators and all who value linguistic and cultural heritage.

Today, as I make this historic Statement on the floor of this august House, I have brought with me 25 pupils and their teachers from the schools where this pilot would be taking place. They are here with us in the public gallery.

Mr Speaker, with this project, we in Ahanta West are showing the way of other lesser-known languages. There are five constituencies that make up Ahanta area, including the Sekondi-Takoradi Metropolis, our original capital. By

igniting the fire, we hope that we would spread the study of Ayinda across these areas in the future. This is not merely a cultural project; it is an educational one. Evidence from global educational research confirms that teaching children in their language significantly enhances literacy, comprehension and confidence. By enabling children in Ayinda speaking areas to learn their native language means closing gaps in access and quality that long disadvantaged rural and linguistically marginalised communities.

Moreover, this work directly supports Ghana's progress towards Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), Goal four, which calls for inclusive and equitable quality education. It also affirms the cultural rights of minority language groups and demonstrates Ghana's leadership in safeguarding linguistic diversity across Africa. In view of these facts, I respectfully call on the honourable House to support the following recommendations.

The Ministry of Education and Ghana Education Service officially recognise Ayinda as a Ghanaian language of study in Ahanta West Schools. The funding and technical support to be made available for the expansion and mainstreaming of the ongoing pilot programme. That the National Council of Curriculum and Assessment (NACA), collaborates with the Ahanta Bible Project to develop standardised and examinable materials for the Ayinda language.

Mr Speaker, our languages are living archives of our history, identity and

dignity. If we allow Ayinda to disappear, we lose not only a language but a vital part of Ghana's national story. The people of Ahanta West ready to keep their language alive, with the support of this honourable House, we can make that vision a national reality.

Mr Speaker, I would end by saying, *me la b'aasi — Nyamenle Y'ila abiaara*. I thank you. God bless you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, what is the meaning of what you said?

Ms Bissue: That is what I said at the end. That means, "God bless all of you."

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Former Minister for the Region.

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP — Takoradi): Mr Speaker, I am very happy and delighted to contribute to this Statement made by Ms Bissue. It is proper that the Ahanta language is recognised as part of the curriculum, especially for those in that part of Western Region that speak Ahanta. If we take Takoradi, Sekondi, Essikado, part of Shama, Kwesimintsim and Ahanta West, we can go on and on, even up to Cape Three Points. They are all part of the Ahanta-speaking areas of the Western Region.

Mr Speaker, if one does not have a language, naturally one's culture will be lost. In fact, if we look at tribes in Ghana, we usually use language to characterise them. Unfortunately, it seems that the speaking of the Ahanta language is

becoming a major problem in these areas. If we take a place like Takoradi and Sekondi, even in Amanfo, my own area, which have typical Ahanta migrants there, the Ahanta language, Ayinda is gone. If we take parts of Kwesimintsim, they do well a little bit. If we take parts of Ahanta West, like Aponwe, Biahon, Agona Nkwanta, Dixcove, and the rest, they are doing well. But the main cities, like Shama, Sekondi, Essikado, Takoradi, Kansaworodo, and Anaji, we have virtually lost the language being spoken in these areas and I believe that the launch and the reintroduction of the language back into the system will do a bit of service for our people. Because when culture is the programming on the mind, with these symbols of the language, it will be easier for the people to understand their own systems and grow and develop out of ancient or local knowledge and to help grow the economy as well.

Mr Speaker, I support Hon MP for Ahanta West for such a great Statement in this House and I believe that Members of Parliament should support her so that when it gets to the ground, the Ministry of Education will be there to support them with the development of the language. I know that the former Western Regional Secretary of the NPP, Mr Quansah, started the language book. So, I believe that if we can contact the family also in Ahanta, it will help to start with some of the materials that will help work with them.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. Hon Members will take one-one comments because of the indication. So, Leaders, I want to be guided.

Yes, so I will give you the floor.

Mr Philip Fiifi Buckman (NDC—Kwesimintsim): Mr Speaker, I would want to also encourage and say to our Sister that she has done very well. This is a very bold step that Ms Mavis Kukuaa Bissie has taken and I want to say that we are so grateful for that step.

Mr Speaker, as was said earlier, if one comes to the area where Ahanta language is spoken, in fact we have five major paramountcy. We are talking about Sekondi, Essikado, Ketan, Otumfo Bedu Bonsu, Bussia, Lower and Upper Dixcove where all these great paramount chiefs are and they cover a vast area.

In fact, because now the society is made up of mixed persons, especially within Sekondi-Takoradi, Kwesimintsim, Effia among others, the language is dying slowly. SoSo, with this bold step and a national, a constitutional, a cultural and a religious call for us to revive the Ahanta language, I think it is a step that we all need to support with all alacrity, with the strengths that we have, so that the Ahanta language would also survive and come up as one of the major languages that we speak and learn in our schools. Because if these children, especially those who have come here, lose track of their language, their spirituality is lost, their culture is lost and their religion is lost.

5.37 p.m.

In fact, their tradition is lost and they may not be able to say where they are from and what language they speak.

We congratulate our Sister for this bold step. In fact, may I humbly say that she can be termed as the queen of the Ahanta language.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leadership?

Deputy Minority Leader (Ms Patricia Appiagyei): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I would like to contribute by commending our Sister, the Hon Member for Ahanta West, Ms Mavis Kuukua Bissie, for making such an important Statement. It is important because it is even being proposed at this point in time in our Parliament that we use our local language to communicate, so that the people who we represent will be able to understand whatever we are discussing here and whatever laws we are promulgating over here—These things will be allowed.

The Hon Member in making this Statement has made it imperative that it is about time we looked at the possibility of using our local language to educate and to give us a lot of wisdom and understanding in whatever we pursue. I agree with the recommendations our Sister made that this should be included in the curriculum. It is very important

because of the number of districts and regions that are able to speak this particular language. But in all, I see a very challenging issue for which, by listening to Hon Kwabena Darko, a lot of work has already been done. He actually recommended for the Hon Minister to contact the individual who has started work on that one.

I believe that because of the expense involved in translating the current books into the various languages, it is important that at this critical stage of our development as a country, we begin to look at how we can assign the right funding to ensure that we use our local dialect. Mr Speaker, reference is always made to China, that because they use their local language, they are able to do impossible things or they are able to advance, to innovate and also understand whatever they are doing. So, it is important that as a country, we rethink through our medium of expressing ourselves in whatever we do.

So, I commend the effort made by the Hon Member for suggesting the inclusion of the language in the curriculum, but more importantly, I want to say that it should be extended to most of the languages. There are other languages that we can classify and then make it—I know that we have a number of languages, but we can classify the languages and make it small enough for good implementation.

With these few words, I want to thank the maker of the Statement and highly commend her for this effort.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leadership?

Yes, Prof Grace Ayensu-Danquah?

Prof Grace Ayensu-Danquah (NDC — Essikadu-Ketan): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for allowing me to make a comment on the Statement given by Hon Kuukua Bissue from Ahanta West.

Mr Speaker, it is very important that we speak our local language and also be taught in our local languages. As we all know, tomorrow, the Prime Minister of India would be in this august House. He would be speaking in Hindi, which is his local language, and we will get the translation of what he is saying. I believe that he doing that is not necessarily for the Ghanaian audience, but for the audience in India who would be watching him; he wants them to understand.

When we speak in our local language and when we learn in our local language, it leads to better comprehension. And not only does it lead to better comprehension, it also helps with citizenry participation. Because if I can stand here and speak Ahanta, which is also my language — I see that the Ahanta language is disappearing — it would be very important and it will also empower the girls or the children in Ahanta land, so that they would also know that we have people in this House who are speaking their language.

So, Mr Speaker, I am very happy that this topic has come up. I believe that even with education—I also believe that Prof Naana Jane Opoku-Agyemang, the

current Vice President of Ghana, has been talking about this for a while. She has been talking about us teaching our children in local languages. I can use myself as an example, Mr Speaker. I have had so many years of education; I believe 17 years of postgraduate education. But sometimes, when I am reading something, just to be able to comprehend it internally, I translate it into my language, so that I can really comprehend what I am reading. So, I am sure it would also change the exam scores in the country. It will make a huge difference that I do not think that it is calculable now; we cannot measure it now. But once we start doing that, I truly believe that it will eventually show in our exam results. It will also show in the pride of Ghanaians. For those of us in this House, if we are also able to speak our languages here, I think it will lead to better open governance participation and buy-in of our constituents.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I would like to say thank you to her for bringing up such an important topic. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

We have come to the end of that Statement.

We have another Statement standing in the name of Hon Patricia Appiagyei on the Role of Monitoring and Evaluation in Good Governance.

You have the floor, subject to the same limitation, one from each Side and the Leadership.

Role of Monitoring and Evaluation in Good Governance

Deputy Minority Leader (Ms Patricia Appiagyei): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I rise to speak on a matter central to our shared responsibility of ensuring accountability, transparency and impactful governance, that is, the urgent need to strengthen Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) systems across Ghana's public sector.

In recent years, Ghana has witnessed increased public expenditure across various sectors, from infrastructure to education, health and social protection. Yet, the outcomes of many of these programmes remain disappointing. Why do so many well-funded interventions fail to achieve their intended objectives? Why do we continue to see projects that stall, investments that do not yield returns, and programmes that are rebranded and repackaged every four years?

Mr Speaker, the answer lies in our collective failure to institutionalise and prioritise robust Monitoring and Evaluation systems. As highlighted in the recent lecture titled, "Strengthening Monitoring and Evaluation for Effective Governance and Accountability in Ghana" by Prof Kwaku Appiah-Adu and Samuel Aning, Monitoring and Evaluation systems in our public sector are fragmented, underfunded, and often treated as afterthoughts rather than strategic governance tools.

5.47 p.m.

Mr Speaker Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E), are the bedrock of results-based management. Monitoring is the systematic collection of data on inputs, activities, and outputs. Evaluation, on the other hand, assesses outcomes and impacts. Together, they provide us with the evidence we need to answer critical questions: are we doing the right things? Are we doing them right? And are we getting value for money?

Mr Speaker, the failure to embed M&E in our governance systems results in policies being shaped by political instincts rather than empirical evidence. As noted by the World Bank (2020) in its report "Building Effective Institutions: The Role of M&E in Governance Reform", countries that embed M&E into the heart of their decision-making process record higher development returns and greater public trust.

This is not a matter of theory. Across Latin America, for example, countries such as Mexico and Colombia have demonstrated how institutionalised national evaluation systems can be used to inform policymaking and budget allocations. In Mexico, the National Council for the Evaluation of Social Development Policy (CONEVAL) is empowered by law to assess all major social programmes and ensure that findings are acted upon. Ghana can and must emulate such examples.

Mr Speaker, the benefits of effective M&E are undeniable. Robust M&E

systems, as seen in effective democracies worldwide, improve decision-making by providing credible data for policy design and resource allocation.

They enhance accountability by tracking whether public funds are used as intended, thereby fostering public trust. They drive efficiency by detecting bottlenecks early and enable this Parliament to exercise its oversight role with independent and relevant information.

However, Mr Speaker, M&E in Ghana faces several systemic constraints: Ministries lack the technical capacity to design rigorous evaluations; M&E units, where they exist, are under-resourced; and the findings that emerge rarely inform budgetary decisions or policy corrections. Worse still, traditional paper-based reports and *ad hoc* site visits simply cannot deliver the timely and actionable data required to respond to evolving challenges in real time. There is also minimal linkage between performance data and budgetary decisions.

Mr Speaker, a study by the Centre for Learning on Evaluation and Results (CLEAR-AA, 2019) indicated that only 38 per cent of Ministries in Ghana had functioning M&E frameworks and even fewer made their findings public. This reality is unacceptable in a democratic society where citizens expect results, not rhetoric.

Mr Speaker, if we are to safeguard public trust, curb corruption, and ensure value for every cedi spent, the Government must prioritise and Parliament must demand an overhaul of

our M&E framework. I call for the following actions:

First, we must enact a National Monitoring and Evaluation Policy that mandates M&E components in all major policies and programmes. Amend existing legislation to require every Ministry, Department, and Agency (MDAs) to embed M&E components at the design stage and to publish regular, standardised reports on inputs, outputs, outcomes, and impact.

Second, Mr Speaker, this House must demand regular M&E reports from MDAs. Every MDA must be required to appear before the relevant Committee each quarter with evidence of M&E findings, highlighting successes, flagging challenges, and proposing remedial actions. These sessions must be made public to enhance transparency. These reports should form the basis of budget and policy hearings, ensuring that funding is tied to performance data. A national M&E system leveraging technology must be developed to provide timely feedback.

Third, we must create mechanisms to ensure M&E results inform parliamentary debates, audits, and policymaking. This will empower Hon Members to hold the Government accountable and ensure that public investments deliver results.

Fourth, Mr Speaker, budget allocations must be linked to performance data. The Government must institute

performance-based budgeting, so that future funding is contingent on demonstrated progress against clearly defined indicators, ceasing the flow of funds to projects that fail to meet agreed milestones. This is a practice adopted in the performance-based budgeting model of South Africa.

Fifth, the Government must provide training for civil servants and parliamentarians on M&E tools and the interpretation of findings. This will equip us to scrutinise Government performance effectively.

Mr Speaker, by adopting these measures, we will empower Parliament to exercise genuine oversight, deter corrupt practices and ensure that every programme delivers meaningful benefits for our citizens. I trust that this House will act decisively to strengthen the M&E architecture of our nation, thereby securing the integrity and success of public investments for all Ghanaians.

Mr Speaker, this House must be reminded that effective parliamentary oversight cannot be based on anecdotal claims, political allegiance or glossy project brochures. It must be based on verifiable, disaggregated, and timely data, which is the very essence of what M&E provides. If we are to regain the trust of the Ghanaian people, we must champion a new era of data-driven governance.

The African Union's Agenda 2063 envisions an Africa where development is driven by evidence-based policy-making and citizen-centred planning.

Ghana, as a model of democracy in the sub-region, must lead by example.

Mr Speaker, let us reaffirm today that Monitoring and Evaluation is not a donor-imposed checkbox; it is a sovereign necessity. It is how we make sure that promises made are promises delivered. It is how we move from inputs and intentions to real, measurable and lasting impact for our people.

Let us act now to institutionalise M&E as a permanent feature of our governance landscape. The stakes are high, but the rewards, for our democracy, our development and our citizens, are even higher.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Richard Acheampong?

Second Deputy Majority Whip (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity. Let me thank the Deputy Minority Leader for a very well-researched Statement, talking about how to implement M&E.

Mr Speaker, we have talked about monitoring and evaluation for more than a decade. I remember the past Administration even created a Ministry for monitoring and evaluation.

5.57 p.m.

I remember at the Committee level, I raised this very issue. If we go to all the

Ministries and look at their budget lines, we will see an expenditure in respect of monitoring and evaluation. So, I asked if we are not duplicating efforts here, but the answer provided was simple: that they would create a dashboard, so, at the click of a button, they can identify whatever is happening in all the agencies. Physically, one does not need to travel to the MDAs; it is like what Ghana Integrated Financial Management Information System (GIFMIS) was put there to do, so that, at least, we can monitor what everyone is doing.

Hon Akoto-Osei, may his soul rest in perfect peace—Mr Speaker, by the end of the day, we could not achieve that expected result. But I saw a policy document in respect of that. So, we can still improve upon it. Because when we are talking about value for money, if we do not monitor what has been allocated to the agencies, how would we know what they are using those scarce resources for?

Mr Speaker, every year, State-Owned Enterprises (SOEs) sign a performance contract with the President and they give out the Key Performance Indicators (KPIs), thus what they want to achieve by the end of the period. By the end of the day, many of them even run at losses. Mr Speaker, can you imagine a state institution running at a loss and, at the same time, paying bonuses to workers? What informed that decision? Because payment of bonuses is hinged on profitability.

How can a company run at a loss and, at the same time, pay bonuses to

workers? It is because nobody is monitoring what is happening. We give budget allocation to institutions; we want value for money, but who is doing the monitoring for us? At the end of the day, we come back to square one. So, we need to get feedback. We have Committees in place; we do the approval of allocation to MDAs. Even, sometimes, getting information from state institutions becomes a challenge.

The former Minister for Information is here. We passed the Right to Information (RTI) Bill. Even the processes that one goes through to get some information—Sometimes, one needs to pay for some classified information before he or she can do his or her work. So, if I want to work for the state and I need some information, I need to pay money to get that information. If I do not have a budget of my own, how can I be effective to do all these things?

So, it is the right time to revisit this issue; as a House, let us see how we can navigate and get things done properly. Because, sometimes, when we are having a conversation with somebody and we complain about certain things, the question they ask is if were you not the same people who approve the Budget and the loans, so how can we tell them we do not know what they use that money for.

For example, we hear budget support, but we do not even know what they use that money for and the Minister will not come and give us a detailed account of the utilisation of those resources. So, these are some of the

challenges we have as a House. But we can improve upon it and we can only do that when we come together. We should put aside our partisan politics and make sure that we demand accountability from state institutions.

I remember we visited Takoradi for this market project. After doing the value for money audit on the original allocation that we gave to them, they made a savings of about US\$3 million. They applied that US\$3 million to expand the scope of work, so if we did not ask them to do the value for money audit, that US\$3 million would never be accounted for. A lot is happening, but we have a lot to do as a House. But at the end of the day, the resources allocated to state institutions are accounted for.

I thank the Deputy Minority Leader very much for bringing this up. We need efficiency; let state institutions become resource-oriented institutions. So, at the end of the day, we can go to sleep that we have given money to people and there will be positive results from those resources allocated to them.

Mr Speaker, I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah (NPP — Ofoase Ayirebi): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity and I want to associate myself with the commendations that have come in to the Deputy Minority Leader for this very well-researched Statement. The subject of monitoring and evaluation, I think, is one that we have not taken as seriously as we should as a Republic.

Mr Speaker, monitoring and evaluation is one of the top five things that we should be doing in Government. We should be enhancing capacity, planning better, financing better, and executing better. But above all, we should be monitoring and evaluating what we are doing.

Mr Speaker, permit me to give a small historical account of how, under the Fourth Republican Constitution, we have tried it. You will recall that in the first two terms, it was still in the early days of the Constitution, so the systems were not very robust. During the Kufuor Administration, that was when we started the programme-based budgeting and introduced what they call the results framework. Then the Mills Administration even took it further by institutionalising a system where we now have planning from the national through the regional to the district level to the National Development Planning Commission (NDPC). If you read Articles 86 and 87 of the Constitution, you will find that there is an elaborate provision on how it should be done.

Mr Speaker, the Mahama Administration resorted, among other things, to an in-house evaluation system. You will recall Dr Tony Aidoo and the work that he assisted the Administration to do. You will recall the Akufo-Addo Administration, as he rightly mentioned, introduced a Ministry and then later downgraded it to a secretariat. It is true that it has been fractured.

Mr Speaker, I think the reason is that we are not following what the

Constitution says and now we are having a lot of duplications, whether at the Presidency level or across MDAs. The Constitution, in Article 86, dealing with the NDPC and 87, specifically, if you look at 87(2)(e), it says:

(2) The Commission shall, at the request of the President, or Parliament, or on its own initiative—

(e) monitor, evaluate, and co-ordinate development policies, programmes, and projects.”

So, the constitutional thinking directs us to let the NDPC lead in this exercise. Unfortunately, after the first two Presidents that I mentioned, we have tried to do it on an *ad hoc* basis and where I add to the submissions made is that we should go back to what the Constitution provides and mainstream monitoring and evaluation under the NDPC. Mr Speaker, the reasons, as I have mentioned, it is constitutionally provided for.

Secondly, they have already started building very strong institutional mechanisms, as I mentioned, during the Mills era, from national to regional to district.

Thirdly, Mr Speaker, they have the tools that are respected across board, whether in-country or in other jurisdictions. Global best practices on how to do monitoring and evaluation—Because currently what is happening is that the same person doing the work is doing his monitoring and evaluation.

And when you see some of the reports that have come, it is the very person who has done the work who is marking his own script.

Mr Speaker, in executing this, a few suggestions to help what the Deputy Leader has mentioned:

First, I think we need to go back and look at the National Development Planning System Act, 1994 (Act 480). Though it borrows from the mandate and spells out how planning should be done, it does not spell out the process by which the monitoring and evaluation should be done. My view is that we should tidy it up a bit more by amending Act 480 to include these M&E structures that are already existent in the constitutional mandate and the National Development Planning Commission Act, 1994 (Act 479).

Additionally, Mr Speaker, I think that the funding that is now being held at MDAs for monitoring and evaluation should be shared, at least, with the NDPC, so that they are able to do a better exercise of monitoring and evaluation. The Ministry can budget it as part of their its project, but my view is that the execution of the monitoring and evaluation should be done in consonance with the NDPC.

Finally, Mr Speaker, the NDPC publishes what the annual progress reports or the annual performance reports (APRs) for MDAs. Unfortunately, they are not taken very seriously. I think this Statement and the conversations that are going on bring us to a point where we

should mainstream these annual performance reports. Leader, yesterday, we were having a conversation about the types of reports that should go to Public Accounts Committee and which ones should go to the sector Ministries.

6.07 p.m.

It is a fine opportunity for us to mainstream these APRs so that they become the terminal report, if I can say so, of the work that has actually been done across Ministries, Departments and Agencies.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity and I commend the Deputy Leader for this very deeply researched Statement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Vondee, two minutes.

Mr David Theophilus Dominic Vondee (NDC— Twifo Atti Morkwa): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity and let me thank the Deputy Leader for a very wonderful and well-researched Statement.

Mr Speaker, I think that monitoring and evaluation is like setting a goal and going back to see whether what you said you want to do has been achieved. If we do not take monitoring and evaluation seriously, then it means that whatever it is that we want to do, we would not know whether it is properly done. I will give you a typical example. Mr Speaker, the politicisation of our developmental agenda is just too much. Remember the

Cocoa Road that His Excellency John Dramani Mahama started in 2016. If we had done proper monitoring and evaluation and allowed that project to continue. Today, most of the roads that were started would not get deteriorated again for us to now be in need of money to solve them— monitoring and evaluation.

Mr Speaker, it is only when we have a national developmental agenda, like my Brother Kojo mentioned, and we work at it practically but not only mentioning it, that we can get proper monitoring and evaluation. Why would the Government start a project and because it is out of power, even though it is the taxpayers' money that was spent to do that particular project, another Government comes and that project is abandoned? Well, not a project like the National Cathedral, but I am saying that projects that are nationalistic, developmental projects that are started by a government and the fact that the Government loses power does not mean that we should leave it to rot.

Look at the schools under tree projects that I keep talking about every day that His Excellency Prof Mills instituted. If we can re-look at all these things practically and look at the law, among others, unless we practicalise the monitoring and evaluation system.

Mr Speaker, even in this House we do not have a committee on monitoring and evaluation, which I think is very important. So again, how will you know whether what you set out to do is being achieved or not? So, I want to thank the

Leader for this very important Statement. It is one of the things that we all would have to think about and look at and put politics aside and be able to look at it properly, so that the things that we set to do—I believe strongly that if monitoring and evaluation were properly done, the Bank of Ghana building that the experts gave accounts that building it would be about US\$80 million would not end up being US\$260 million if monitoring and evaluation was done practically and successfully. Mr Speaker, it is very important that monitoring and evaluation is given proper attention in this House.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, conclude.

Mr Vondee: Those who do not want me to talk about the reality and the truth—but the point is that monitoring and evaluation must happen at all time in our governance system in order to have proper accountability and that is what we need. Other than that, we will be dilly-dallying and be talking about things that are not really relevant and nobody wants to talk about the truth, but I will. I thank you very much for the opportunity and God bless you. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. Hon Members, Statement time has ended.

Yes, Majority Leader.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think we have had enough and we are in your hands, if you can take—

Tomorrow at 9.00 a.m, we expect everybody in the Chamber. We are expecting the Prime Minister at exactly 10.00 a.m. The whole ceremony should not last more than 30 minutes. So, I urge Colleagues to try and be here on time. We will start proceedings at 9.00 a.m. and then by 10.00 a.m. when the Prime Minister arrives, we should all be seated and ready to listen to him. So, on that note, Mr Speaker, we are in your hands.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. The House is accordingly adjourned till Thursday, 3rd July, 2025 at 9.00 a.m. before noon.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned at 6.15 p.m. till Thursday, 3rd July, 2025, at 9.00 a.m.

